

ETH-01 · CODE OF ETHICS

The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct

The conduct instrument binding every PCI candidate and certificant

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The Institute's code of ethics and professional conduct: the standard of behaviour required of everyone who applies for, sits for or holds a PCI credential. It states eight principles and then gives them operative effect in numbered obligations covering the reporting of numbers, competence, confidentiality, conflicts of interest, commercial dealing, artificial intelligence and data, conduct towards the Institute and its examinations, the raising of concerns, and what happens when the Code is breached. It is a professional instrument, not a statement of law, and clauses are numbered so that any one of them can be cited exactly in a decision.

— About this document

Document	ETH-01
Series	Code of Ethics
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	9

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. Status and authority	6
1.1 What this Code is	6
1.2 Why the Institute maintains a code	6
1.3 Effect	6
1.4 What this Code is not	6
1.5 Commencement and supersession	7
1.6 Precedence	7
1.7 Founding-stage status	7
2. Scope — who is bound, and when	7
2.1 Persons bound	7
2.2 Membership grades	8
2.3 Conduct covered	8
2.4 Territorial application	8
2.5 Obligations that survive	8
3. Interpretation	9
3.1 Definitions	9
3.2 Reading conventions	9
3.3 Relationship to law	9
3.4 Relationship to employer policy	10
4. The principles	10
4.0 How the principles work	10
4.1 Integrity of the numbers	10
4.2 Competence and its limits	10
4.3 Confidentiality	10
4.4 Conflicts of interest	10
4.5 Fair dealing in commercial matters	10
4.6 Refusal to misstate	11
4.7 Duties to the profession and the Institute	11
4.8 Governed use of AI	11
5. Obligations in preparing and reporting numbers	11
5.1 Truthfulness	11
5.2 Assumptions, basis and limits	11
5.3 Selective truth	11
5.4 Cut-off, accrual and period discipline	12
5.5 Progress, quantities and rules of credit	12
5.6 Schedule integrity	12
5.7 Correction of error	12
5.8 Records	12
5.9 Refusal and escalation	13

6. Obligations to those who rely on the work	13
6.1 Who relies	13
6.2 Information bearing on safety, the environment and the public	13
6.3 Where interests conflict	13
6.4 The limit of the obligation	13
7. Obligations to the employer or client	14
7.1 Diligent service	14
7.2 Advocacy and its boundary	14
7.3 Instructions	14
7.4 After leaving	14
8. Competence and currency	14
8.1 Working within competence	14
8.2 Declaring the limit	14
8.3 Currency	15
8.4 Supervision	15
8.5 Representing qualifications	15
9. Confidentiality and information handling	15
9.1 What is protected	15
9.2 Purpose limitation	15
9.3 Disclosure	15
9.4 Personal data	15
9.5 Tools and transmission	15
9.6 Survival	16
9.7 Personal advantage	16
10. Data and artificial intelligence	16
10.1 The rule	16
10.2 Verification	16
10.3 The duty to explain	16
10.4 Transparency	16
10.5 Confidential data in AI tools	16
10.6 Accountability is not delegable	17
10.7 Record	17
11. Conduct in relation to the Institute and its examinations	17
11.1 Honesty in dealings	17
11.2 Conduct in examination	17
11.3 Examination content	17
11.4 Cooperation and reporting	18
11.5 Use of the designation	18
12. Conflicts of interest	18
12.1 The standard	18
12.2 Disclosure	18
12.3 Safeguards and withdrawal	18
12.4 Self-review	19

12.5 Inducements.....	19
13. Raising concerns	19
13.1 Route	19
13.2 To the Institute	19
13.3 Good faith	19
13.4 What the Institute can and cannot do	19
14. Breach and consequences.....	20
14.1 What is a breach	20
14.2 Assessing seriousness.....	20
14.3 Fair process	20
14.4 Range of outcomes	20
14.5 Appeal	20
14.6 What is not a defence	20
15. Review, amendment and language	21
15.1 Review	21
15.2 Amendment	21
15.3 Transitional rule	21
15.4 Language	21
Related	21
Sources and standards.....	21
Status and version	22

The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct

In one paragraph. This is the Institute's code of ethics and professional conduct: the standard of behaviour required of everyone who applies for, sits for or holds a PCI credential. It states eight principles and then gives them operative effect in numbered obligations covering the reporting of numbers, competence, confidentiality, conflicts of interest, commercial dealing, artificial intelligence and data, conduct towards the Institute and its examinations, the raising of concerns, and what happens when the Code is breached. It is a professional instrument, not a statement of law: legal duties and protections differ between countries, sectors and employment arrangements, and nothing here replaces qualified local advice. Clauses are numbered so that a manager, an investigator or a certificant can point at one exactly — ETH-01 §5.7 — in a conversation, a report or a decision.

Who this is for. Candidates for and holders of PCI credentials; the managers, sponsors, auditors and employers who rely on their work; and anyone conducting or answering a conduct case under PCI governance.

— 1. Status and authority

1.1 What this Code is

This Code states the conduct the Institute requires of the people it certifies. It is the senior conduct instrument of the Project Controls Institute: where another Institute policy addresses the same behaviour in more detail, that policy governs the detail and this Code governs the principle.

1.2 Why the Institute maintains a code

Project controls is a discipline of trusted numbers. A forecast, a variance analysis, a progress valuation or a risk register is only useful to the person relying on it if they can assume it was prepared honestly, competently and without a hidden agenda. Everything a controls professional produces is an input to somebody else's decision — to fund, to stop, to pay, to escalate, to reassure a board. This Code exists so that a PCI credential carries that assumption for every holder, everywhere.

1.3 Effect

Acceptance of this Code is a condition of applying for, sitting for, holding and renewing a PCI credential. A person bound by it is answerable to the Institute for compliance with it, and the Institute's response to a breach operates on the person's standing with the Institute — see §14.

1.4 What this Code is not

1.4.1 It is not law, and it does not describe, create, extend or replace any legal right, duty, defence or protection.

1.4.2 It is not legal advice, and the Institute does not give legal advice to candidates or certificants.

1.4.3 It is not a contract of employment, and it does not override a lawful and proper instruction from an employer except in the specific respects stated in §7.3.

1.4.4 It does not give a third party any right to enforce it. The Institute enforces it, through decisions about certification and candidature and nothing else.

1.5 Commencement and supersession

1.5.1 This Code supersedes and expands the Institute's earlier Code of Professional Conduct, which was issued under a credential code that has since been retired. The eight principles of that document are carried forward without change of substance; this Code adds scope, definitions, operative obligations, the treatment of artificial intelligence and data, and the consequences of breach.

1.5.2 Commencement: [CONFIRM: commencement date for this Code, and the date on which the predecessor Code of Professional Conduct is withdrawn from the Downloads Centre].

1.5.3 Conduct is judged under the version of the Code in force at the time of the conduct — see §15.3.

1.6 Precedence

Where this Code, an Institute policy and an employer's policy all speak to the same behaviour, they are read in this order:

Rank	Instrument	What it governs
1	Applicable law of the place where the person works	Everything. Where the law requires something this Code does not, the law governs.
2	This Code	The professional standard required by the Institute
3	The Institute's specific policies — examination rules, appeals, complaints, privacy, AI standard	The operational detail within the principle
4	The employer's or client's own policies	Everything not inconsistent with the above

A stricter employer policy is followed. A more permissive employer policy does not lower the standard in this Code.

1.7 Founding-stage status

The Institute is at founding stage and says so. PCI is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by any accreditation body. This Code describes obligations the Institute imposes and enforces itself; it should not be read as implying external recognition, endorsement or statutory standing of any kind.

2. Scope — who is bound, and when

2.1 Persons bound

This Code binds:

- 2.1.1 every applicant for a PCI credential, from the moment an application is submitted;
- 2.1.2 every candidate — a person holding a live examination authorisation, whether or not the examination has been sat;
- 2.1.3 every certificant — a holder of a current PCI credential (PCL-AI, PFL-AI or PML-AI) or of the AI in Project Controls — Specialist Certificate;
- 2.1.4 every former certificant, in respect of conduct that occurred while they were bound, and in respect of the continuing obligations at §2.5;
- 2.1.5 every person who has been awarded a credential by a route that does not require an examination, on the same terms as any other certificant.

2.2 Membership grades

Membership of the Institute and certification by the Institute are different ladders and are not conflated here. A member who also holds a PCI credential is bound by this Code as a certificant. Whether a member who holds no PCI certification is bound is not yet settled: [CONFIRM: whether this Code binds PCI members who hold no PCI certification, and if so from which membership grade].

2.3 Conduct covered

- 2.3.1 This Code applies to conduct in professional life: work performed, advice given, records made, representations made, and dealings with employers, clients, colleagues and the Institute.
- 2.3.2 It applies to conduct outside professional life only where that conduct bears directly on the trust reasonably placed in a holder of the credential — for example, dishonesty in a matter of personal finance that a reasonable employer would regard as relevant to entrusting the person with cost data.
- 2.3.3 It does not give the Institute a general licence to police private life, and a conduct case is not opened on that basis.

2.4 Territorial application

This Code applies wherever the person works. It is written to be jurisdiction-neutral: it states professional obligations, not the law of any country. Where a professional obligation in this Code and the law of the place where a person works appear to conflict, §3.3 governs.

2.5 Obligations that survive

The following continue after an engagement, an employment or a certification ends:

- confidentiality of information obtained in the course of the work (§9);
- confidentiality of examination content (§11.3);
- honesty about certification status held, formerly held or never held (§8.5, §11.8);
- cooperation with an Institute investigation into conduct that occurred while bound (§11.5), for so long as the person seeks to hold, restore or reapply for a credential.

— 3. Interpretation

3.1 Definitions

Term	Meaning in this Code
the Institute	Project Controls Institute Global, Inc.
certificant	A holder of a current PCI credential or certificate
candidate	An applicant or a person holding a live examination authorisation
the work	Any professional output: estimate, forecast, schedule, valuation, variance analysis, risk assessment, claim, report, dashboard, model or advice
a number	Any quantified statement in the work — a cost, a date, a percentage, a probability, a quantity, a rating
materially misleading	Capable of changing the decision of a reasonable person relying on it, whether by what it states, what it omits, or how it is framed
AI tool	Any software system that generates, transforms, ranks, predicts or summarises content or values in a way that substitutes for or supplements human analytical judgement
conflict of interest	An interest that could reasonably be seen to influence the person's professional judgement, whether or not it in fact does
detriment	Adverse treatment because a person raised a concern — dismissal, demotion, exclusion, withdrawal of work, or informal disadvantage

3.2 Reading conventions

3.2.1 **Must** states an obligation; failure is a breach. **Should** states expected practice; departure requires a reason the person can articulate and, where the matter is material, record.

3.2.2 **Reasonable** is judged by what a competent practitioner in the same role, with the same information and the same time, would have done — not by hindsight and not by the ideal case.

3.2.3 Headings and the summary paragraph do not limit the clauses.

3.3 Relationship to law

3.3.1 Employment law, whistleblowing protection, data-protection law, anti-bribery and anti-corruption law, securities law, competition law, company law and professional-liability law differ substantially between jurisdictions — and within a jurisdiction they differ between sectors, between employment and contracting arrangements, and over time. **This Code does not state any of them.**

3.3.2 Nothing in this Code should be read as an assurance that a course of action it requires, permits or encourages is lawful, protected or free of consequence in a particular place. In some jurisdictions a disclosure of wrongdoing attracts statutory protection subject to conditions; in others the protection is narrow, conditional or absent.

3.3.3 Where the law requires something this Code does not, the law governs. Where a person believes that complying with this Code would require them to break the law, they must say so to the Institute rather than resolve it silently, and the Institute will consider the conflict on its facts.

3.3.4 Before making a disclosure outside their own organisation, before resigning over an ethical matter, and before signing anything they believe to be false, a person **should** take advice from a qualified adviser in their own jurisdiction. The Institute cannot provide that advice and does not underwrite the consequences of a disclosure.

3.4 Relationship to employer policy

Compliance with an employer's policy is not a defence to a breach of this Code, and compliance with this Code is not a defence to a breach of an employer's lawful policy. Where the two genuinely cannot both be satisfied, the person must raise it — internally first, then with the Institute — and record having done so.

— 4. The principles

4.0 How the principles work

Eight principles are stated below. They restate, in the same order and to the same effect, the principles of the predecessor Code of Professional Conduct; the numbering has changed, the substance has not. Each is given operative effect in the numbered obligations at §§5–13. A conduct case cites both — the principle and the obligation.

4.1 Integrity of the numbers

The certificant reports what the evidence shows. Forecasts, variances, progress and risk are stated truthfully, with their assumptions and limits disclosed, whether or not the answer is welcome.

4.2 Competence and its limits

The certificant works within their competence, keeps that competence current, and says so plainly when a task requires expertise they do not have.

4.3 Confidentiality

Cost data, commercial positions, performance information and personal data are protected, used only for the purpose for which they were entrusted, and never traded for personal advantage.

4.4 Conflicts of interest

The certificant's professional judgement is not for sale and not for rent. Actual, potential and perceived conflicts are disclosed before they can colour a conclusion.

4.5 Fair dealing in commercial matters

In valuations, applications for payment, claims, variations and negotiations, the certificant deals honestly. Advocacy for an employer or client is legitimate; misrepresentation is not.

4.6 Refusal to misstate

Being instructed to present a false or misleading number does not excuse presenting it. The duty is escalation, not participation.

4.7 Duties to the profession and the Institute

The value of a PCI credential depends on the integrity of the process that awards it and the honesty of those who hold it. Every candidate and certificant shares in protecting both.

4.8 Governed use of AI

Using AI well is part of professional competence; governing it is part of professional conduct. AI proposes; the professional disposes. Accountability for an output carrying the certificant's name cannot be delegated to software.

— 5. Obligations in preparing and reporting numbers

Gives effect to §4.1, §4.5 and §4.6.

5.1 Truthfulness

5.1.1 A certificant must not state, sign, issue or knowingly transmit a number they believe to be materially false or misleading.

5.1.2 A certificant must not manufacture, suppress, reclassify or reallocate a variance, a cost, a quantity, a date or a risk in order to disguise the position of a project.

5.1.3 A forecast must reflect performance to date and honest assumptions about the remainder. A number selected because it is acceptable, and justified afterwards, breaches §4.1 even if it later turns out to be right.

5.2 Assumptions, basis and limits

5.2.1 Every estimate, forecast and quantitative analysis must carry its assumptions, its basis and its exclusions in a form the recipient will actually see — not only in an appendix that the summary contradicts.

5.2.2 The certificant must state plainly what the analysis cannot support. A single-point forecast presented without its uncertainty, where uncertainty is material, is misleading by omission.

5.2.3 Where a result depends on an assumption that a reasonable recipient would question, the assumption is named in the same breath as the result.

5.3 Selective truth

A statement that is literally accurate may still be materially misleading through selection, framing, aggregation or omission — a favourable subset presented as the whole, a metric shown at the level where it looks best, an adverse trend excluded because it is "not yet confirmed". §5.1 applies to the impression created, not only to the individual figures.

5.4 Cut-off, accrual and period discipline

5.4.1 Cost incurred in a period must be reported in that period, in accordance with the accounting framework and cut-off policy applying to the entity. Recognition frameworks differ between jurisdictions and entities; the obligation here is to apply the applicable one consistently, not to apply any particular one.

5.4.2 Deferring the recognition of a known cost, accelerating the recognition of revenue or progress, or moving a transaction across a period boundary **in order to improve a reported metric**, is a breach of §4.1 regardless of whether the movement is later reversed.

5.4.3 Where a genuine judgement about timing exists, the judgement, its grounds and its effect on the headline metrics are disclosed to the person relying on the report.

5.5 Progress, quantities and rules of credit

5.5.1 Progress is measured by the rule of credit that applies to the work package, applied consistently, and evidenced.

5.5.2 A certificant must not adopt a more generous measurement basis for a period because the period is a reporting boundary, nor apply a rule of credit selectively across packages to produce a target percentage.

5.5.3 Where measured progress and claimed progress differ, the difference is reported, not netted away.

5.6 Schedule integrity

5.6.1 A schedule must represent the plan as it is genuinely intended to be executed, with logic, durations and constraints that a competent reviewer could reconstruct.

5.6.2 A certificant must not conceal or absorb float, apply artificial constraints, break logic, or manipulate calendars or durations in order to make a forecast completion date agree with a required date.

5.6.3 Where the honest calculated completion is later than the required completion, that fact is reported. Mitigation is proposed as mitigation — with its cost, its risk and its owner — not presented as though it had already happened.

5.7 Correction of error

5.7.1 An error discovered in issued work must be corrected promptly and openly, to everyone who received the original and to anyone the certificant knows to be relying on it.

5.7.2 The correction states what was wrong, what the corrected position is, and what decisions may have been affected. Quietly reissuing a corrected file is not a correction.

5.7.3 A certificant must not allow a number they know to be wrong to stand because correcting it is inconvenient, embarrassing or commercially awkward.

5.8 Records

A certificant must keep, for the work they own, a record sufficient for a competent reviewer to reconstruct how a number was produced: the source data, the method, the assumptions, the adjust-

ments made and by whom, and the review or approval applied. Where an instruction changed a reported number, the instruction and its author form part of that record.

5.9 Refusal and escalation

5.9.1 A certificant instructed to prepare, sign or transmit something they believe to be materially misleading must decline.

5.9.2 They must raise the concern through the proper channels of their own organisation — line management, project governance, internal audit, an ethics or compliance route — and keep a factual record of having done so, including dates, recipients and what was said.

5.9.3 Where the concern is not resolved, they must escalate rather than acquiesce by silence, taking advice where the situation warrants it (§3.3.4).

5.9.4 Pressure from an employer, client, manager or sponsor is not accepted by the Institute as a defence to participation in a misstatement. Neither is the fact that the number was ultimately issued by somebody else, where the certificant supplied it knowing how it would be used.

— 6. Obligations to those who rely on the work

6.1 Who relies

The people who rely on project controls output are rarely in the room: an investment committee, a lender, a board, a public body, an insurer, a joint-venture partner, a workforce whose jobs depend on a project's viability. The obligation in §5 exists because of them.

6.2 Information bearing on safety, the environment and the public

6.2.1 A certificant must not suppress, dilute or delay information in their control that bears on the safety of persons, on environmental harm, or on a matter of clear public interest, and must raise it through the appropriate route without waiting to be asked.

6.2.2 Where cost or schedule pressure is being resolved by reducing a control that exists for safety or compliance reasons, the certificant must record and report that as the trade-off it is, rather than as an efficiency.

6.3 Where interests conflict

Where the interest of an employer or client conflicts with the accuracy of information that others will rely on for a significant decision, accuracy prevails. This does not license unilateral external disclosure: it requires the escalation and record in §5.9, and, where the person is considering going outside the organisation, the advice in §3.3.4.

6.4 The limit of the obligation

A certificant is obliged to report honestly, escalate properly and record what they did. They are not obliged to guarantee an outcome they do not control, and the Institute does not treat a person as being in breach because a properly escalated concern was overruled by people with the authority to overrule it.

— 7. Obligations to the employer or client

7.1 Diligent service

A certificant serves their employer or client competently, diligently and in good faith, uses resources for their intended purpose, and does not misuse position, systems or information for personal benefit.

7.2 Advocacy and its boundary

Presenting an employer's or client's position in its strongest honest form is legitimate. The boundary is misrepresentation: asserting as fact what is not established, relying on records the certificant knows to be inaccurate, or allowing a material misstatement made on the employer's behalf to stand uncorrected once the certificant knows of it.

7.3 Instructions

7.3.1 Lawful and proper instructions are followed.

7.3.2 An instruction to produce, alter or withhold a number so as to create a materially misleading impression is not a proper instruction, and §5.9 applies.

7.3.3 An instruction to change a number that comes with a genuine reason — new information, a corrected assumption, a different and defensible method — is not improper merely because it is unwelcome. The distinction is whether the change is supported by evidence and would survive disclosure to the person relying on the report.

7.4 After leaving

Confidentiality survives the engagement (§9.6). A certificant must not take, retain or use an employer's or client's confidential material after leaving, and must not use knowledge of a former employer's confidential commercial position to that employer's disadvantage in a subsequent role — see [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#) for how this is managed in practice.

— 8. Competence and currency

8.1 Working within competence

A certificant undertakes only work they are competent to perform, or work performed under supervision by someone who is, and says so before the work starts rather than after it fails.

8.2 Declaring the limit

Where a task requires expertise the certificant does not hold — a specialist contractual analysis, a statistical method, a taxation or accounting treatment, a modelling technique — they must say so and obtain the expertise, rather than produce an approximation and present it as an analysis.

8.3 Currency

8.3.1 A certificant must maintain their knowledge and skill across the discipline as methods, standards and tools evolve, including the governed use of AI.

8.3.2 Recertification runs on a three-year cycle and includes a mandatory AI-currency component. The binding continuing-professional-development requirement will be published with the recertification rules; the figure shown as a target in the student portal is a target and not a rule, and this Code does not state a required number of hours.

8.4 Supervision

A certificant who supervises others is responsible for the review they said they performed. Signing or approving work implies that the reviewer applied judgement to it — not that they received it.

8.5 Representing qualifications

A certificant must not claim or imply qualifications, experience, employment history or certification status they do not hold, and must correct such a claim promptly if it is made on their behalf.

— 9. Confidentiality and information handling

9.1 What is protected

Cost and rate data, estimates, commercial positions, bid and tender information, contract terms, claims strategy, performance and productivity data, security-relevant design information, personal data, and anything the owner has marked or treats as confidential.

9.2 Purpose limitation

Confidential information is used only for the purpose for which it was entrusted. Using it for a different purpose — a benchmark, a bid, an article, a job application, a study exercise, a demonstration — requires the owner's authority.

9.3 Disclosure

Confidential information is disclosed only with proper authority, or where disclosure is required by law or by a competent authority. Where a certificant believes disclosure is required by law, §3.3.4 applies before they act.

9.4 Personal data

Personal data encountered in the work — payroll, timesheets, competence records, proctoring material, health information supporting an adjustment — is handled on a need-to-know basis and in accordance with the applicable data-protection framework, which differs by jurisdiction.

9.5 Tools and transmission

A certificant must take reasonable care with the tools and channels they use so that confidential information is not exposed to systems outside the owner's control. This includes personal devices,

personal accounts, file-sharing services and AI tools — see §10.5 and [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#).

9.6 Survival

Confidentiality obligations continue after the engagement, the employment and the certification end. There is no point at which commercially sensitive information becomes fair use because time has passed, unless the owner has released it or it has genuinely become public other than through a breach.

9.7 Personal advantage

A certificant must not use confidential information for personal advantage, or enable another person to do so. Dealing in securities, bidding, or arranging a personal or family interest on the strength of non-public project information breaches §4.3 — and may in addition be unlawful, on terms that vary greatly between jurisdictions.

— 10. Data and artificial intelligence

Full treatment is in [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#). The binding obligations are here.

10.1 The rule

AI proposes; the professional disposes. An AI tool may draft a forecast, flag an anomaly, classify a risk or write a narrative. It cannot be accountable for the result. The named human is.

10.2 Verification

A certificant must verify an AI-assisted output against independent evidence — a conventional method, a benchmark, a prior period, their own reasoning — before relying on it, matching the depth of the check to the consequence of being wrong.

10.3 The duty to explain

A certificant must be able to explain, in their own words and without the tool in front of them, what data a submitted number rests on, how it was produced and why it holds. "The model said so" is never a defence, and inability to explain a number you submitted is itself a breach of §4.8.

10.4 Transparency

Where AI's contribution to a conclusion is material, the certificant makes that visible to reviewers and recipients, so that what was machine-proposed can be distinguished from what was human-judged.

10.5 Confidential data in AI tools

A certificant must not enter confidential project, commercial or personal data into an AI tool outside the data owner's control and policies. Anonymisation is not a licence: where the residual detail would still identify the project, the party or the person, the data remains confidential.

10.6 Accountability is not delegable

Output carrying a certificant's name is theirs, whatever produced it. Neither the vendor's terms nor the tool's limitations transfer that accountability.

10.7 Record

Where AI materially contributed to a submitted output, the certificant keeps a short record: the tool, the inputs supplied, the check performed, and the named owner of the result. This is what makes AI-assisted work defensible months later.

— 11. Conduct in relation to the Institute and its examinations

11.1 Honesty in dealings

Every statement made to the Institute — in an application, an eligibility declaration, an accommodation request, a CPD claim, an appeal or an investigation — must be true and complete, and supporting evidence must be genuine.

11.2 Conduct in examination

A candidate must:

11.2.1 present genuine identification and sit the examination personally — impersonation in either direction is among the most serious breaches of this Code;

11.2.2 use no unauthorised material, device, resource or assistance of any kind;

11.2.3 use no AI assistance of any kind during a sitting — including AI assistants, AI-enabled search, AI features embedded in other software, and any tool that generates, retrieves or transforms answer content — however obtained, on the examination device, on a second device, or through another person;

11.2.4 comply with the invigilation and proctoring arrangements published for the sitting, including identity verification, the environment check and restrictions on additional displays;

11.2.5 follow the proctor's instructions throughout, and report a disruption at the time rather than after the result is known;

11.2.6 know the rules published for their own sitting, which set out the full list of permitted and prohibited materials.

The prohibition on AI in the examination does not rest on detection. It rests on the meaning of the credential: a pass obtained with a tool's help would certify the tool.

11.3 Examination content

11.3.1 Examination items are confidential. A candidate or certificant must not disclose, reconstruct, record, share, sell, publish or solicit live examination content, before or after a sitting, however informal the setting.

11.3.2 This obligation is permanent and survives the loss or surrender of a credential.

11.3.3 Preparing others using reconstructed items, or knowingly using reconstructed items to prepare, breaches §4.7 whether or not money changes hands.

11.4 Cooperation and reporting

11.4.1 A candidate or certificant must cooperate openly and truthfully with an Institute investigation, and must not destroy, alter or withhold relevant records.

11.4.2 A candidate or certificant must report to the Institute credible evidence of certification fraud, impersonation or examination misconduct by another person.

11.4.3 Self-reporting: [CONFIRM: whether a certificant must notify PCI of a criminal conviction, regulatory finding or dismissal for dishonesty, and within what period].

11.5 Use of the designation

11.5.1 The designation is used only while the person is entitled to it, in the form the Institute publishes, and is discontinued immediately on expiry, suspension or withdrawal.

11.5.2 A certificant must not describe the credential as accredited, government-recognised, equivalent to a degree, or as guaranteeing employment, and must not attribute to it recognition it does not carry. The Institute holds itself to the same standard.

11.5.3 A certificant must not present a membership grade as a certification, or a certification as a membership grade.

— 12. Conflicts of interest

Full treatment is in [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#).

12.1 The standard

A conflict exists where an interest could reasonably be seen to influence professional judgement. The test is what a reasonable, informed observer would think — not whether the certificant believes themselves to be objective.

12.2 Disclosure

12.2.1 A certificant must disclose an actual, potential or perceived conflict promptly, in writing where the matter is material, to the person or body able to act on it, and before the judgement in question is exercised.

12.2.2 A disclosure states the interest, its size or closeness, the decisions it touches, and what the certificant proposes should happen.

12.3 Safeguards and withdrawal

Where a conflict can be managed — by reallocation, independent review, exclusion from a decision, or an information barrier — the safeguard is recorded and applied. Where it cannot be managed, the certificant declines the work or withdraws from it.

12.4 Self-review

A certificant must not provide independent assurance over their own work, or over work they directed. Preparing an estimate and then auditing the same estimate is not independence, however capable the individual.

12.5 Inducements

A certificant must not accept or offer any inducement intended to influence a professional conclusion, a valuation, a certification, an award or a decision. Gifts and hospitality are governed by the applicable employer policy and by law, both of which vary; the obligation in this Code is that nothing is accepted or offered which the certificant would be unwilling to disclose to the person relying on their judgement.

13. Raising concerns

Full treatment is in [ETH-06 – Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions](#).

13.1 Route

A concern about conduct is ordinarily raised first within the organisation where it arises, through line management, project governance, audit, or an ethics or compliance route, and recorded.

13.2 To the Institute

A concern about the conduct of a PCI candidate or certificant may be raised with the Institute by anyone, including a person outside the Institute: [\[CONFIRM: the published address and web route for raising a conduct concern with PCI\]](#).

13.3 Good faith

A person who raises a concern honestly and on reasonable grounds is not in breach of this Code because the concern is not upheld. Raising a concern known to be false, or raising one to harass or gain advantage, is itself a breach.

13.4 What the Institute can and cannot do

13.4.1 The Institute will not treat a person adversely in their standing with the Institute because they raised a concern in good faith.

13.4.2 The Institute cannot protect a person from an employer's response, cannot compel an employer to act, and cannot confer any legal protection. Whether an external disclosure attracts legal protection depends entirely on local law and the circumstances — §3.3 applies, and advice should be taken before acting.

— 14. Breach and consequences

14.1 What is a breach

A failure to meet an obligation stated as a **must** in §§5–13, or conduct inconsistent with a principle in §4 that is serious enough to bear on the trust placed in the credential.

14.2 Assessing seriousness

The factors considered include: whether the conduct was deliberate, reckless or careless; the materiality of the effect and who was exposed to it; whether it was concealed; whether it was repeated; the person's seniority and the reliance placed on them; whether they self-reported and corrected; whether they cooperated; the pressure they were under, which may mitigate but does not excuse; and any previous finding.

14.3 Fair process

A person facing a conduct case is told what is alleged and on what evidence, is given a genuine opportunity to respond, and is judged by people with no conflict of interest in the matter. The decision is recorded with reasons.

14.3.1 [CONFIRM: which PCI body determines conduct cases at first instance, and its relationship to the Certification & Impartiality Committee].

14.3.2 [CONFIRM: whether PCI may impose an interim suspension of a credential while an investigation is in progress, on whose authority, and on what test].

14.4 Range of outcomes

Outcomes are proportionate to the breach and range from guidance and a recorded warning, through conditions on continued certification, to suspension and — in serious cases — withdrawal of certification. Where the conduct concerns an examination, an outcome may also include invalidation of a result and loss of the right to resit.

14.4.1 The Institute does not publish a fixed tariff of sanctions in this Code, and none should be inferred: [CONFIRM: the published sanction range and any tariff, including the minimum period before a person whose certification has been withdrawn may reapply].

14.4.2

[CONFIRM: whether conduct outcomes are published, in what form, with or without identification, and for how long].

14.5 Appeal

An adverse decision carries a right of appeal, heard by people independent of the original decision. The routes, the grounds and the time limits are in [ETH-06](#) and in the Institute's published appeals policy; this Code states no timescale, because none should be invented.

14.6 What is not a defence

Instruction from a manager, client or employer; commercial pressure; local custom; the fact that others do the same; the absence of a specific prohibition in an employer's policy; ignorance of this Code; or the fact that the misstatement was never acted upon.

— 15. Review, amendment and language

15.1 Review

This Code is reviewed under PCI governance: [\[CONFIRM: the review cycle for this Code and the body that approves amendments\]](#).

15.2 Amendment

Amendments are versioned. A change that alters what a person must do is a major version and is notified to certificants before it takes effect.

15.3 Transitional rule

Conduct is judged under the version of the Code in force at the time of the conduct. Where the current version is more favourable to the person, the current version applies.

15.4 Language

The English text is the authoritative version. Translations are provided for convenience; where a translation and the English text differ, the English text governs.

— Related

- [ETH-02 – The principles explained](#) — the reasoning behind each of the eight principles, and where each one bites
- [ETH-03 – Reporting numbers under pressure: a casebook](#) — the obligations in §5 worked through realistic, fictitious dilemmas
- [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#) — the operative detail behind §12
- [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#) — the operative detail behind §10
- [ETH-06 – Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions](#) — how §13 and §14 actually run
- [CER-07 – Results, scoring, appeals and complaints](#) — the candidate-facing view of the same routes

— Sources and standards

- PCI Code of Professional Conduct (predecessor instrument), [docs/downloads/code-of-professional-conduct.md](#), repository copy read August 2026. This Code carries forward its eight principles without change of substance. The predecessor was issued under a credential code that has since been retired; the current project-controls credential is **PCL-AI**.
 - PCI Candidate AI-Use Policy, [docs/downloads/candidate-ai-use-policy.md](#), repository copy read August 2026 — source of the examination position at §11.2.3 and the practice position at §10.
-

- PCI Candidate Handbook, <docs/downloads/candidate-handbook.md>, repository copy read August 2026 — source of the examination conduct rules at §11.2 and the appeals and complaints separation at §13.
- ISO/IEC 17024:2012, Conformity assessment — General requirements for bodies operating certification of persons. Referenced as a design principle for impartiality and fair process, described here in our own words. PCI is developed with reference to it and is **not accredited** by any accreditation body.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.

ETH-02 · CODE OF ETHICS

The principles explained

What each of the eight principles requires, why it exists, and where it actually bites

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT

2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.

AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

A clause-by-clause reading of the eight principles in the PCI code of ethics and professional conduct: what each one requires in ordinary work, the reasoning that puts it in the Code, the point at which it stops being obvious and starts costing something, and what it does not require. Written for the practitioner who accepts the principles in the abstract and wants to know what they mean on a Thursday afternoon when a report is due.

— About this document

Document	ETH-02
Series	Code of Ethics
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	0

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. Why the principles need explaining at all	4
2. Integrity of the numbers (§4.1)	4
3. Competence and its limits (§4.2)	5
4. Confidentiality (§4.3)	6
5. Conflicts of interest (§4.4)	6
6. Fair dealing in commercial matters (§4.5)	7
7. Refusal to misstate (§4.6)	7
8. Duties to the profession and the Institute (§4.7)	8
9. Governed use of AI (§4.8)	8
10. How the principles interact	9
11. How this goes wrong	10
12. The four questions	10
Related	10
Sources and standards	11
Status and version	11

The principles explained

In one paragraph. This document takes the eight principles in [ETH-01](#) one at a time and explains what each requires in ordinary work, why the Institute thinks it belongs in a code at all, the point at which it stops being obvious and starts costing something, and what it does not require. It is not a summary of the Code; it is the reasoning underneath it, which is what a practitioner needs when the situation in front of them is not the one the clause was written for.

Who this is for. Cost engineers, planners, quantity surveyors, controls managers and heads of function who have read the Code, agree with all of it, and want to know how it behaves under load.

— 1. Why the principles need explaining at all

A code of ethics fails in one of two ways. Either it is so abstract that everyone agrees with it and nobody can apply it, or it is so specific that any situation not on the list feels permitted.

The eight principles in [ETH-01 §4](#) are deliberately at the general level. That means they need reasoning attached, because a practitioner facing a real decision is almost never in the textbook case. They are being asked to change one word. The number is defensible either way. The person asking is not a villain and has a real argument. The deadline is in forty minutes.

Principles are what you use when the rule does not quite fit. So each of the eight is set out below in the same shape: **what it requires, why it is in the Code, where it bites** — the point at which compliance costs something — and **what it does not require**, because a principle read too widely is abandoned as unworkable.

One observation runs through all eight, and it is the single most useful thing in this document. Almost nobody breaches a code of ethics in one step. The breach is reached by a sequence of individually reasonable concessions: a softer adjective, a rounder number, an assumption left unstated because everyone knows it, a caveat moved to an appendix, a date nobody believes but nobody has formally revised. Each step is smaller than the one before it, and the last one is the smallest of all. This is why the principles are written as habits rather than as prohibitions on dramatic acts.

— 2. Integrity of the numbers (§4.1)

What it requires. That the number you report is the number your evidence supports, together with the assumptions it rests on and a plain statement of what it cannot tell the reader.

Why it is in the Code. Everything a controls function produces is an input to somebody else's decision. A cost report is not a document; it is the reason a board does or does not release the next tranche of funding. The discipline's entire claim on professional standing rests on the reported position being independent of what anyone wants it to be. Remove that and the function is a presentation service.

Where it bites. Not in the fabricated number — those are rare, and everyone recognises them. It bites in three quieter places.

The first is **framing**. Every figure in a report can be literally correct while the report as a whole misleads: a portfolio-level roll-up that conceals two failing packages, a variance shown against a revised budget without saying the budget moved, a trend chart that starts at the month after the bad one. [ETH-01 §5.3](#) treats the impression created as the thing being tested, and that is deliberate.

The second is **silence about uncertainty**. A single-point completion forecast reported without any statement of range, in circumstances where the range is wide and known to be wide, misleads by omission. The professional habit is to state the number, the basis and the sensitivity together, so that they travel as one object and cannot be separated by somebody making a slide.

The third is **the number you did not update**. An estimate that was reasonable in March and is indefensible in September is not saved by having been prepared honestly. Integrity includes revisiting the number when the evidence moves.

What it does not require. It does not require pessimism. Controls professionals sometimes drift into treating the low number as suspect and the high number as safe, which is its own distortion — an inflated forecast destroys value as reliably as an optimistic one, by holding contingency that could have funded something else and by teaching everyone to discount your figures. It does not require certainty; it requires honesty about how much you have. And it does not require you to win the argument. Reporting the honest number and being overruled by people entitled to overrule you is compliance, provided you reported it and it is on the record.

— 3. Competence and its limits (§4.2)

What it requires. That you take on work you can actually do, get help where you cannot, keep your knowledge current, and never claim what you do not hold.

Why it is in the Code. Incompetent work does the same damage as dishonest work and is more common. The person relying on your quantitative schedule risk analysis cannot tell from the output whether you understood the correlation assumptions in it. They are relying on your professional statement that you did.

Where it bites. At the moment of admission, and it bites hardest on senior people. A graduate saying "I have not done this before" is unremarkable. A controls manager saying it about a probabilistic method their director assumes they know is expensive, and that is exactly the moment the principle exists for. The practical form is narrow and specific: "I can build and run this model; I am not confident specifying the correlation between these two duration ranges, and that assumption drives the answer. I want an hour with someone who is."

It also bites on **currency**, which is where the discipline is moving fastest. Methods that were adequate five years ago are still adequate; tools that were adequate five years ago are not. The Institute treats the governed use of AI as part of competence rather than as an optional extra (§4.8), which means the practitioner who refuses to engage with it is making a competence choice, not a neutral one.

What it does not require. It does not require you to refuse anything you have not done before — that is how a career fails to develop and how a function becomes brittle. Stretch is legitimate; the

condition is that the stretch is visible to whoever is relying on the work, and supervised in proportion to the consequence of being wrong.

— 4. Confidentiality (§4.3)

What it requires. That information entrusted to you is protected, used only for its intended purpose, and never turned to personal advantage — during the engagement and after it.

Why it is in the Code. Controls professionals see the commercially decisive material: the rates, the margins, the bid position, the claims strategy, the productivity that the client has not been told about. Access on that scale is granted only where the recipient is assumed to be safe.

Where it bites. Rarely in the deliberate leak; usually in **purpose creep**. Rates from one client used to sanity-check an estimate for another. A schedule taken to a new employer because you built it and it feels like yours. A screenshot in a conference talk with the logo cropped but the activity names intact. A benchmarking exercise that pools numbers nobody was asked about. Each of these has an innocent motivation and each is a use the owner did not authorise.

It bites again on **anonymisation**, which people over-trust. A cost breakdown with the client name removed is still identifying if the scope, the country and the year are recoverable from it — and in project controls they almost always are, because the details that make data useful are the details that make it traceable.

And it bites at the **exit**. The rule that survives employment is genuinely a rule: material stays, knowledge in your head travels, and confidential commercial positions do not become usable because you changed employer. [ETH-04](#) deals with what that means when you cross to the other side of a contract.

What it does not require. It does not require you to un-learn your profession. Skill, method, judgement and general market awareness are yours. The line is between capability you developed and information you were given.

— 5. Conflicts of interest (§4.4)

What it requires. That interests capable of being seen to influence your judgement are disclosed before the judgement is exercised, and managed or avoided.

Why it is in the Code. Because the test is perception, not integrity. Assurance has no value if the reader has to take the assessor's self-belief on trust. The principle protects the reader, and it protects you: a disclosed interest that later comes to light is an administrative fact, whereas an undisclosed one is the story.

Where it bites. On the honest person, which is the part people miss. The corrupt practitioner is not troubled by this principle. The person it constrains is the one who genuinely believes — often correctly — that they can be objective about a supplier run by their brother-in-law. The Code asks a different question: what would a reasonable, informed observer conclude? That question has a different answer, and it is the one that binds.

It bites second on **self-review**: preparing an estimate and then auditing it, writing a procedure and then assessing compliance with it, owning a forecast and chairing the panel that challenges it. This is the most common structural conflict in a controls function, it is almost always created by re-sourcing rather than by intent, and it is invisible from inside because everyone knows everyone is trying their best. [ETH-04](#) sets out how to fix it without a bigger team.

What it does not require. It does not require you to have no relationships, no history and no prior employer. It requires you to say what they are.

— 6. Fair dealing in commercial matters (§4.5)

What it requires. That valuations, applications for payment, claims and variations honestly reflect the work done and the contract's terms, and that advocacy stays inside the boundary of what the records support.

Why it is in the Code. Because in commercial work the professional is expected to be partisan, and a code that ignored that would be ignored in return. This principle does not ask you to be neutral between your employer and the counterparty. It draws the line in the only place it can sensibly be drawn: you may present your side's case in its strongest honest form; you may not assert as fact what you know not to be established.

Where it bites. On the difference between an **arguable position** and a **manufactured one**. A claim built on genuine records, argued to the top of its range, is legitimate professional work. A claim built by selecting the records that survived, by measuring the same delay twice under two headings, or by pricing a variation using rates the contract does not support, is not — and the practitioner usually knows precisely which one they are constructing, because the manufactured one requires them to avoid certain documents.

It also bites at **year-end and at cut-off**, where the pressure to measure generously is at its peak and where a percentage moved by seven points across a large package moves real money. [ETH-03](#) works that case through in detail.

What it does not require. It does not require you to volunteer your side's weaknesses to the counterparty, to concede an arguable entitlement, or to negotiate against yourself. Advocacy is legitimate. Misrepresentation is not.

— 7. Refusal to misstate (§4.6)

What it requires. That when you are instructed to produce or transmit something you believe to be materially misleading, you decline, escalate through the proper channel, and keep a record.

Why it is in the Code. Because this is the principle that costs the most, and because the instruction is the ordinary way a misstatement happens. Almost no controls professional wakes up intending to mislead a board. They are asked, by someone senior, for something that sounds reasonable in the room.

Where it bites. In the gap between refusing and resigning. Practitioners frequently believe those are the only two moves, conclude that resignation is unaffordable, and therefore comply. The Code requires a third thing, and it is the useful one: decline the specific act, put the position in writing,

escalate it once through the channel that exists, and record what you did. That sequence is proportionate, it is available to a person who cannot afford to lose their job, and it is what the Institute will look for if the matter is ever examined.

It bites again on **records**, which people neglect precisely when they are most under pressure. A dated note of what you were asked, what you said and to whom is the difference between a professional who escalated and a professional who says they did.

The Code is explicit that pressure is not a defence (ETH-01 §5.9.4). It is equally explicit that being overruled after proper escalation is not a breach (ETH-01 §6.4). Both halves matter: the first prevents "I was told to" from working, and the second prevents the principle from demanding heroism from people with no authority.

What it does not require. It does not require you to escalate every disagreement about method. Competent professionals differ about EAC technique, about accrual judgement and about risk exposure, and those are arguments, not conduct matters. The threshold is a number or a statement you believe to be materially misleading — capable of changing the decision of a reasonable person relying on it.

— 8. Duties to the profession and the Institute (§4.7)

What it requires. Honesty in every dealing with the Institute; integrity in the examination; permanent confidentiality of examination content; cooperation with an investigation; accurate use of the designation.

Why it is in the Code. A credential is a shared asset. Its value to every holder is set by the weakest process anyone got through. A candidate who obtains a pass with help devalues the credential of every candidate who did not — including their own, which is the part that makes it a professional matter and not merely a rule.

Where it bites. On **examination content after the sitting**, which candidates routinely underestimate. Posting recalled questions in a study group feels generous. It is a breach, it is permanent, and it is treated seriously because item banks are expensive to build and trivially destroyed. It bites again on **describing the credential accurately**: the Institute is at founding stage, is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 principles, and is not accredited. A certificant who overclaims on a profile page is doing to the Institute exactly what §4.1 forbids doing to a sponsor.

What it does not require. It does not prohibit teaching, coaching or writing about the discipline. Explaining a method, publishing a worked example and preparing candidates are all legitimate and useful. The line is live examination content — the items themselves — not the subject matter they test.

— 9. Governed use of AI (§4.8)

What it requires. That AI-assisted output is verified before reliance, that you can explain a number you submitted in your own words, that a material AI contribution is visible to reviewers, and that confidential data does not go into tools outside the owner's control.

Why it is in the Code. Because accountability cannot follow the work into the tool. When a forecast produced with AI assistance turns out to be wrong, the sponsor's question is not which model was used but who checked it. The Institute's formulation — AI proposes; the professional disposes — is a statement about where accountability sits, not a statement about how much automation is appropriate.

Where it bites. On the **explanation test**, and it bites hard. Ask yourself whether you could, without the tool open, tell a sceptical reviewer what data the number rests on, what method produced it, which assumption it is most sensitive to, and what would have to be true for it to be wrong. If you cannot answer all four, you are not yet the author of that number, and submitting it under your name breaches the principle regardless of whether the number is correct.

It bites second on **confidential data**, where the failure is casual rather than considered: pasting a cost breakdown into a general-purpose tool to get a quick summary. The useful discipline is a single question asked before pasting anything — would I be comfortable if the data owner watched me do this?

It bites third on **deskilling**, which is slower and more serious. A practitioner who has never performed the calculation cannot sense when the output is wrong, and sensing that is most of what experience is for.

What it does not require. It is not an anti-AI position, and reading it as one misreads the Institute entirely. The credential exists partly to certify governed AI use. Nothing here restricts drafting, exploration, code generation, summarisation or analysis support. The requirement attaches at the point of submission: when the output leaves you carrying your name.

— 10. How the principles interact

Real dilemmas engage several principles at once, and the Code is designed so that they do not contradict each other. A useful order of resolution when more than one applies:

1. **Is anything about to be stated that is materially misleading?** (§4.1, §4.5) If yes, that dominates. Nothing else in the Code authorises it.
2. **Am I competent to judge that?** (§4.2) If not, the obligation is to say so, not to guess.
3. **Is my judgement compromised by an interest?** (§4.4) Disclose before deciding, not after.
4. **What may I say, and to whom?** (§4.3) Confidentiality governs the route of a concern, not whether it may be raised.
5. **If I am being instructed, what is the proportionate response?** (§4.6) Decline the act, escalate once, record it.
6. **Can I explain and defend what I am about to submit?** (§4.8) If not, it is not ready to leave your desk.

Note what step 4 does and does not do. Confidentiality is a frequent excuse for silence and is almost never a valid one: it shapes where a concern goes, not whether it goes anywhere.

— 11. How this goes wrong

"It is only a presentational change." The most common route into a breach. Presentation is where misleading happens; the individual figures usually survive audit intact.

Treating the code as a document you agree with rather than a test you apply. The principles are worth nothing unless they are consulted before the report goes out, at the moment the concession looks small.

Escalating by hint. A raised eyebrow in a meeting is not an escalation and will not be found by anyone reviewing the matter later. If it is worth raising, it is worth writing in one factual paragraph.

Escalating everything. A practitioner who treats every methodological disagreement as an ethics matter loses the standing to raise the one that counts.

Confusing loyalty with obedience. The employer's interest is served by knowing the true position early. A professional who tells a director what they want to hear is not being loyal; they are transferring risk from the meeting to the project.

Waiting for certainty before speaking. By the time a doubt is fully evidenced, the number is usually issued and the decision is usually taken. The Code's threshold is reasonable belief, not proof.

— 12. The four questions

Before anything leaves your desk carrying your name:

1. **Is it true, including the impression it creates?** Not just each figure — the whole.
2. **Can I explain it without the file open?** The data, the method, the sensitivity, the failure mode.
3. **Would I be content for the person relying on it to see how it was produced?** Including the instructions that shaped it.
4. **If I am wrong, will the record show what I actually did?** Assumptions, checks, escalations, dates.

A number that fails any of these is not ready. A practitioner who answers all four honestly, every time, will never need the disciplinary sections of the Code — and will occasionally have a very uncomfortable week, which is the price of the standing the credential is supposed to carry.

— Related

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) — the binding clauses these principles explain
- [ETH-03 – Reporting numbers under pressure: a casebook](#) — the same principles applied to specific, fictitious dilemmas
- [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#) — the operative detail behind §4.4

- [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#) — the operative detail behind §4.8
- [CMP-09 – Behavioural and leadership competencies](#) — how the behaviours described here are assessed as competence

— Sources and standards

- PCI Code of Professional Conduct (predecessor instrument), [docs/downloads/code-of-professional-conduct.md](#), repository copy read August 2026 — the source of the eight principles.
- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) (this framework) — the clause numbering cited throughout.

No external sources are cited in this document, and none are implied. The reasoning is the Institute's own, offered as PCI interpretation of its own Code.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.

ETH-03 · CODE OF ETHICS

Reporting numbers under pressure — a casebook

Five fictitious dilemmas, the clause that governs each, the options ranked, and the words to say

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

Five constructed, explicitly fictitious cases in which a project controls professional is pressed to report something other than what the evidence shows: a forecast softened before a board meeting, an accrual deferred to protect a monthly cost performance index, float concealed to preserve a completion date, a progress claim measured generously at year-end, and a caveat removed after sign-off. Each case sets out the situation, the pressure, the clauses of the PCI code that govern it, the practical options ranked from best to worst, and the words a professional can actually say in the room. All figures are illustrative.

— About this document

Document	ETH-03
Series	Code of Ethics
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	0

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. A note on the cases, and on what they are not	4
2. Case one — the forecast the director wants softened	5
2.1 The situation	5
2.2 The pressure	5
2.3 What the Code requires	5
2.4 The options, ranked	6
2.5 What you actually say	6
2.6 If you are overruled	7
3. Case two — the accrual that slips into next month	7
3.1 The situation	7
3.2 The pressure	7
3.3 What the Code requires	8
3.4 The options, ranked	8
3.5 What you actually say	9
4. Case three — the float that disappears	9
4.1 The situation	9
4.2 The pressure	10
4.3 What the Code requires	10
4.4 The options, ranked	10
4.5 What you actually say	11
5. Case four — the generous measure at year-end	11
5.1 The situation	11
5.2 The pressure	12
5.3 What the Code requires	12
5.4 The options, ranked	12
5.5 What you actually say	13
6. Case five — the caveat that was removed	13
6.1 The situation	13
6.2 The pressure	14
6.3 What the Code requires	14
6.4 The options, ranked	14
6.5 What you actually say	15
7. What the five cases have in common	15
8. Three sentences worth having ready	16
Related	16
Sources and standards	16
Status and version	16

Reporting numbers under pressure — a casebook

In one paragraph. This casebook takes five situations in which a project controls professional is pressed to report something other than what the evidence shows — a forecast softened before a board meeting, an accrual deferred to protect a monthly cost performance index, float concealed to preserve a completion date, a progress claim measured generously at year-end, and a caveat removed after sign-off — and works each one through in the same structure: the situation, the pressure, what the Code requires, the practical options ranked from best to worst, and the words a professional can say in the room. Every case is invented for teaching. Every figure is illustrative.

Who this is for. Cost engineers, planners, quantity surveyors and controls managers who will be asked one of these questions at some point in their career, and their managers, who will be the ones asking.

— 1. A note on the cases, and on what they are not

Every case in this document is fictitious. The situations are constructed to teach; the organisations, roles, projects and numbers are invented; no case describes, is based on, or alludes to any real project, employer, client or person. Nothing here is a report of anything that happened.

They are written in a deliberately unhelpful shape: in each one, the person applying the pressure has a reasonable argument, the number in dispute is genuinely uncertain, and the professional cannot afford a dramatic gesture. That is the realistic case. Dilemmas in which a villain demands a lie are easy and rare.

Three things recur across all five, and they are the reason the casebook exists.

The request is always about presentation, never about truth. Nobody says falsify the forecast. They say is there a way to present this that does not derail the meeting. There usually is, and sometimes it is entirely legitimate — which is what makes the question hard.

The number is usually within a defensible range. The pressure is applied at the edge of that range, not outside it, and then applied again next month from the new edge. Ratchets are how reporting positions drift.

The deciding question is not "is this figure defensible?" but "would the person relying on it change their decision if they could see how it was produced?" That is the test in [ETH-01 §3.1](#) under materially misleading, and it resolves four of the five cases below on its own.

A note on currency and rounding. Figures are stated in a generic **currency unit (CU)** so that no jurisdiction's tax, accounting or contractual treatment is implied. Money is rounded to the nearest whole unit; indices are shown to three decimal places; percentages of a stated base are shown to one decimal place. Every calculation shows its substitution.

— 2. Case one — the forecast the director wants softened

Fictitious case. Illustrative figures.

2.1 The situation

You are the project controls manager on a delivery programme with an approved budget at completion of **CU 120,000,000**. The board meets on Thursday. Your team's estimate at completion, built bottom up from committed cost, accrued cost, remaining work priced at current rates, and a risk allowance, is **CU 128,400,000**.

That is an overrun of:

$$128,400,000 - 120,000,000 = 8,400,000$$

$$8,400,000 \div 120,000,000 = 0.070 = 7.0 \% \text{ of approved budget}$$

The programme's governance rule — a rule you helped write — requires the board to be told when the forecast overrun exceeds 5 % of approved budget. Five per cent of CU 120,000,000 is CU 6,000,000, so the threshold sits at a forecast of CU 126,000,000. Your number crosses it.

On Tuesday the project director asks you to "look again" at the forecast and see whether it can be "presented at around 122". That figure implies an overrun of CU 2,000,000, or 1.7 % of approved budget, comfortably inside the threshold.

$$122,000,000 - 120,000,000 = 2,000,000$$

$$2,000,000 \div 120,000,000 = 0.017 = 1.7 \% \text{ of approved budget}$$

The gap between the two forecasts is **CU 6,400,000** — the difference between a report that triggers board scrutiny and one that does not.

2.2 The pressure

The director is not corrupt and is not asking you to invent anything. Their argument is genuinely arguable: two of your assumptions are conservative, a commercial settlement is expected within six weeks that may recover part of the exposure, and a recovery plan is being drafted. They point out — correctly — that a forecast is a judgement, that your CU 128,400,000 has a range around it, and that CU 122,000,000 is inside that range. They add that going to the board with 7 % will trigger an intervention that will consume the team for a month and make recovery less likely.

You also know three things they have not said: the board approved this budget nine months ago on the strength of your predecessor's forecast; the director's variable remuneration is affected by programme outturn; and if you report 122 and the settlement does not land, you will be reporting a larger overrun in three months with less credibility.

2.3 What the Code requires

- **ETH-01 §5.1.3** — a forecast must reflect performance to date and honest assumptions. **A number selected because it is acceptable, and justified afterwards, is a breach even if it later turns out to be right.** This is the clause that decides the case: the sequence matters, not only the result.

- [ETH-01 §5.2](#) — assumptions, basis and exclusions travel with the number, in a form the recipient will actually see.
- [ETH-01 §5.3](#) — the test applies to the impression created, not only to each figure.
- [ETH-01 §7.3.3](#) — an instruction to change a number is not improper merely because it is unwelcome. If the director's assumptions are better than yours, adopting them is correct professional practice.

The line between §7.3.3 and §5.1.3 is the whole case, and it is drawn in one place: **is the change driven by evidence, or by the destination?** A settlement with a signed heads of terms and a defined value is evidence. A settlement that is "expected" is an assumption — and an assumption may be adopted, but it must be visible, attributed and reversible.

2.4 The options, ranked

1. Report the honest forecast, and give the director the recovery narrative they actually need. Present CU 128,400,000 as the current forecast, with the range, the assumptions and — critically — a clearly separated statement of what would have to be true for the outturn to be CU 122,000,000: the settlement value, its probability, its timing, and the recovery actions with owners and dates. This is better for the director than the softened number, because it puts the recovery case in front of the board as a plan rather than as an unexplained improvement. It also protects them: they can say they disclosed early.

2. Re-run the forecast with the director's assumptions made explicit, and report both. Show the base case at CU 128,400,000 and a stated-assumption case at CU 122,000,000, with the assumptions named in the same table. Legitimate, and honest, provided neither is presented as the forecast without the other and the base case is not relegated to an appendix. Ranked second only because two numbers in front of a board invite the wrong one to be quoted.

3. Adopt a genuinely better assumption where the director has actually persuaded you. If the challenge exposes a conservative allowance you cannot defend, change it — and record why, in the basis of estimate, before the meeting rather than after it. The forecast may legitimately fall to, say, CU 126,900,000. It falls to whatever the evidence supports, not to the threshold.

4. Report the softened number with a caveat buried in the pack. Not acceptable. This is the option people actually take, and it fails [ETH-01 §5.3](#) precisely: every figure is defensible and the document misleads.

5. Report CU 122,000,000 as the forecast. A breach of §5.1.3, and one that compounds: next month you either report the same number you no longer believe, or you explain a CU 6,400,000 movement that did not happen this month.

2.5 What you actually say

"I can't put 122 up as the forecast, because I'd be starting from the answer. What I can do is show the board the bridge: base case 128.4, and what has to land to get to 122 — the settlement at its expected value, and the four recovery actions with owners. If the settlement is signed before Thursday, I'll rebuild the forecast on it and the number moves properly. If you want, I'll draft the recovery slide with you this afternoon so it lands as a plan rather than as a variance."

Then, whatever is decided, send one short factual note the same day: the forecast you provided, the basis, and what was agreed for the pack. Not an accusation — a record. [ETH-01 §5.8](#).

2.6 If you are overruled

If the pack goes out at CU 122,000,000 over your objection, you have not breached the Code by being overruled (ETH-01 §6.4), but three obligations remain live. Your own record must show the forecast you supplied and to whom (§5.8). You must not personally sign or present the softened figure as your forecast (§5.1.1). And if the misstatement is material and goes to the board unaltered, you must escalate once through the channel that exists — audit, governance, or the sponsor — and record it (§5.9.3). That sequence is available to someone who cannot afford to resign, which is the point of it.

— 3. Case two — the accrual that slips into next month

Fictitious case. Illustrative figures.

3.1 The situation

You are the cost engineer for a work package with a budget at completion of **CU 96,000,000**. At the month-14 cut-off your figures are:

Measure	Value at cut-off
Earned value (EV), cumulative	CU 42,000,000
Actual cost (AC), cumulative, invoices received	CU 41,000,000
Subcontractor work performed, not yet invoiced	CU 1,900,000

The CU 1,900,000 is not in dispute. The work was done before cut-off, the field engineer has signed the measurement sheet, and the invoice is late because the subcontractor's commercial team is short-staffed. Under the entity's accounting policy it should be accrued into month 14.

The reporting rule on this programme flags any package amber where the cumulative cost performance index falls below 1.000.

With the accrual excluded:

$$\text{CPI} = \text{EV} \div \text{AC} = 42,000,000 \div 41,000,000 = 1.024$$

With the accrual included:

$$\text{CPI} = \text{EV} \div \text{AC} = 42,000,000 \div 42,900,000 = 0.979$$

The commercial manager suggests that since the invoice "hasn't arrived", the cost "isn't ours yet", and it can go into month 15 — where it will be diluted by a larger cost base and, with luck, offset by a productivity improvement everyone expects.

3.2 The pressure

This one is dangerous because it is dressed as a technicality, and because it is reversible. Nothing is being invented and nothing is being destroyed; a cost is merely landing in the next box. Every-

one involved expects the numbers to catch up. The person suggesting it is not asking you to lie — they are asking you to apply a timing judgement in the direction that helps.

Two things make it worse than it looks.

It moves the index across the threshold that governs attention. The whole purpose of the amber flag is to direct scrutiny to packages performing below plan. A package at 0.979 gets scrutiny; a package at 1.024 does not. The deferral does not soften a message, it deletes it.

It moves the forecast by more than the accrual. Using the cost-performance-index method for the estimate at completion — one of several defensible methods, and the one this programme's reporting standard uses — the effect is:

$$EAC = BAC \div CPI$$

$$\text{Including the accrual: } EAC = 96,000,000 \div 0.979 = 96,000,000 \times (42,900,000 \div 42,000,000) = 98,057,143$$

$$\text{Excluding the accrual: } EAC = 96,000,000 \div 1.024 = 96,000,000 \times (41,000,000 \div 42,000,000) = 93,714,286$$

$$\text{Difference} = 98,057,143 - 93,714,286 = 4,342,857$$

$$4,342,857 \div 96,000,000 = 0.045 = 4.5 \% \text{ of budget at completion}$$

Assumption stated with the answer: this estimate at completion assumes the remaining work is performed at the cumulative cost performance index — see [BPG-09 – Estimate at completion](#) for when that assumption is and is not appropriate. The point stands under any method that uses cumulative actual cost: a deferred accrual of CU 1,900,000 changes the reported forecast by roughly **CU 4.34 million**, or about 4.5 % of budget at completion. A CU 1.9 million timing decision is moving a CU 4.3 million forecast.

3.3 What the Code requires

- [ETH-01 §5.4.1](#) — cost incurred in a period is reported in that period, under the accounting framework and cut-off policy applying to the entity.
- [ETH-01 §5.4.2](#) — deferring a known cost **in order to improve a reported metric** is a breach regardless of whether it later reverses. The reversal is not the mitigation; it is the mechanism.
- [ETH-01 §5.4.3](#) — where a genuine timing judgement exists, the judgement, its grounds and its effect on the headline metrics are disclosed.
- [ETH-01 §4.1](#) — integrity of the numbers, of which cut-off discipline is the least glamorous and most frequently breached part.

Note what §5.4.3 permits. If the accrual were genuinely uncertain — a disputed measure, an unagreed rate, a contested quantity — a decision to hold it out of the period could be entirely proper. What makes this case a breach is that the reason offered is the effect on the index, not the quality of the evidence.

3.4 The options, ranked

1. Accrue it, report the index at 0.979, and lead with the explanation. The amber flag is not the bad news; the underperformance is. Report the accrual, the index, the resulting forecast, and the one-page reason: which activities underperformed, by how much, what is being done. A package explained is a package trusted.

2. Accrue it and add a like-for-like note. Where the previous month's report was not on a consistent accrual basis, say so and show both bases for one period, so the movement is not misread as a sudden collapse. Fixing a cut-off weakness openly is legitimate; doing it silently is not.

3. Escalate the systemic problem separately. If invoices routinely arrive after cut-off, that is a process defect creating a monthly temptation. Raise it as a controls issue — a standing accrual process with the subcontractor's measurement sheets as the trigger — so the judgement stops being made under pressure each month. Ranked third because it does not resolve this month.

4. Defer it and flag it in a footnote. Not acceptable. The index is what will be read; a footnote does not repair a metric that has crossed a control threshold. Fails §5.3 and §5.4.2.

5. Defer it silently. A clear breach of §5.4.2, and the one that is easiest to prove afterwards, because the measurement sheet is dated and the invoice will eventually arrive with a service period on it.

3.5 What you actually say

"The work was done in month 14 and it's measured, so it accrues in month 14 — if I move it, the index isn't a measure of anything. Yes, it takes us to 0.979 and the package goes amber. Let me put the reason next to it: it's the two shifts we lost on the mechanical face and a re-work item. If we report it now with the recovery plan, amber is a controlled position. If we defer it and report it in month 15 alongside whatever month 15 does, we lose the ability to explain it at all."

And if the answer is "put it in next month anyway": that instruction should be given by the person who owns the accounting policy, in writing, with their reason. Most requests of this kind do not survive the sentence "can you confirm that in an email so I can reference it in the working papers?" — which is not a threat, merely the record [ETH-01 §5.8](#) requires you to keep.

— 4. Case three — the float that disappears

Fictitious case. Illustrative figures.

4.1 The situation

You are the planning engineer on a plant project. Contractual mechanical completion is programme **day 610**. This month's update, with progress applied and logic unchanged, calculates mechanical completion at **day 628** — eighteen days late.

The project manager does not dispute the progress. They ask for two changes before the report is issued:

1. Apply a finish no later than constraint to the mechanical completion milestone at day 610, so the reported date matches the contract; and
2. Reduce four downstream commissioning activities whose durations currently total **46 days** to a total of **28 days**, on the basis that "we will resource up".

$46 - 28 = 18$ days of duration removed

$18 \div 46 = 0.391 = \text{a } 39.1\% \text{ reduction in the remaining commissioning durations}$

No additional resource has been identified, no cost has been added, and no method statement has changed. Separately, the electrical containment path currently shows 24 days of total float, and you

have been asked to "use some of that" by extending its activities to absorb the slip — which would leave the path with zero protection while showing an on-time finish.

4.2 The pressure

This is the case practitioners rationalise most easily, for three reasons. Schedules are models, and models involve choices. Compression is a real technique. And the requested output — an on-time completion date — is what everybody is trying to achieve anyway, so producing it feels like alignment rather than misstatement.

The pressure is amplified by the fact that a late date in the report has contractual consequences that a late date in reality does not yet have. Reporting day 628 may trigger a notice obligation, a liquidated-damages conversation, or a client intervention. Reporting day 610 defers all of that — for a month.

4.3 What the Code requires

- [ETH-01 §5.6.1](#) — a schedule represents the plan as it is genuinely intended to be executed, with logic, durations and constraints a competent reviewer could reconstruct.
- [ETH-01 §5.6.2](#) — a certificant must not conceal or absorb float, apply artificial constraints, break logic or manipulate durations **in order to make a forecast completion date agree with a required date**. All three requests fall inside this clause.
- [ETH-01 §5.6.3](#) — where the honest calculated completion is later than the required completion, that fact is reported; mitigation is proposed as mitigation, with its cost, risk and owner, not presented as though it had already happened.
- [ETH-01 §5.2.1](#) — the basis travels with the number. A schedule whose constraints are invisible to the reader has no basis attached.

The constraint request also has a second-order effect worth naming to the project manager, because it is the argument most likely to land: **float that has been consumed to hide a slip is no longer available to absorb the next one**. After the change, the electrical path has zero protection and the report says the project is on time. The next disruption — of any size — becomes an immediate contractual date failure with no warning, and the report that should have provided the warning has been configured not to.

4.4 The options, ranked

1. Report day 628, and present compression as a costed option. The honest forward pass is the report. Alongside it, present the compression genuinely: which four activities, what additional resource, what it costs, what risk it adds, who owns it, and what the completion date becomes if approved and resourced. That is a mitigation plan. Approve it, resource it, and the durations change legitimately in next month's update.

2. Report day 628 and quantify the exposure precisely. Eighteen days, on which paths, driven by which activities, with the float position on the near-critical paths stated so the reader can see how much protection remains. A planner who reports a slip and its anatomy is doing the job; one who reports only the date invites the shoot-the-messenger response.

3. Model the constrained scenario as an explicitly labelled scenario. A separate, named scenario file showing what would have to be true to finish at day 610 is a legitimate analytical

product, and often persuasive. It is not the schedule, it is never issued as the schedule, and the labelling is not negotiable.

4. Apply the constraint and mention it in the narrative. Not acceptable. Readers of a programme read dates and float, not narrative. Fails §5.6.2 directly.

5. Compress the durations with no basis, or absorb the electrical float. The most damaging option, because it destroys the schedule's usefulness as a warning system while leaving it looking healthy. It also tends to be discovered later — by a delay analyst, in a claim, with the audit trail of exactly who changed what and when.

4.5 What you actually say

"I can produce a programme that finishes on day 610, but only by constraining the milestone or cutting eighteen days out of commissioning durations without a resource change — and either way the programme stops being a forecast. What I'd rather give you is this: the update says 628, here are the three activities driving it, and here's the compression option costed, with the electrical path float shown. If we approve the resource, the durations change and the date moves for a real reason. If we constrain it now, we lose the twenty-four days of float on electrical and we won't see the next slip until it's a date failure."

If the change is imposed anyway, the record matters more here than in any other case in this book, because scheduling software preserves the evidence. Note the version you issued, the constraint or duration change you were instructed to apply, who instructed it, and the date. [ETH-01 §5.8](#) and [§5.9.2](#).

— 5. Case four — the generous measure at year-end

Fictitious case. Illustrative figures.

5.1 The situation

You are the quantity surveyor for a piping installation package with a value of **CU 12,000,000**. The agreed rules of credit for the package are:

Step	Credit
Fabrication of spools	30 %
Erection	50 %
Testing and reinstatement	20 %

At the December measure, fabrication is complete and the field engineer's verified erection quantity is **82 %** of the erection scope. Testing has not started.

Fabrication: $100 \% \times 30 = 30.0$ points
 Erection: $82 \% \times 50 = 41.0$ points
 Testing: $0 \% \times 20 = 0.0$ points
 Assessed completion = $30.0 + 41.0 = 71.0$ %

The application for payment being prepared claims **78 %**. To reach 78 % under the same rules of credit, erection would have to be at:

$$(78 - 30) \div 50 = 48 \div 50 = 0.96 = 96 \% \text{ erected}$$

Against 82 % verified. The commercial lead's justification is that spools for the remaining sections are fabricated, delivered to site and "effectively installed", and that the difference will be true within three weeks anyway.

The value at stake:

$$\text{Each percentage point of the package} = 12,000,000 \div 100 = \text{CU } 120,000$$

$$\text{Claim difference} = (78 - 71) \times 120,000 = 7 \times 120,000 = \text{CU } 840,000$$

$$\text{Cross-check via the erection step} = (96 \% - 82 \%) \times 50 \% \times 12,000,000 = 0.14 \times 6,000,000 = \text{CU } 840,000$$

5.2 The pressure

The timing is not incidental. This is the year-end measure, it feeds a revenue recognition position, and the difference between 71 % and 78 % on this package is one of several similar adjustments across the portfolio. The argument offered is a real one: material delivered to site is value transferred in some contractual regimes, and the work will genuinely be done shortly.

The reason it is nonetheless a breach is narrow and decisive. The rules of credit for this package give **no credit for delivery** — 30 % for fabrication, which has been taken in full, and 50 % for erection, which is measured on what is erected. The claim is not applying a different valid method; it is applying the agreed method to quantities that do not exist yet.

Note also that if delivery genuinely warranted credit, the correct professional route is to propose a change to the rules of credit, agreed with the counterparty and applied consistently to every package, going forward. That route is available, legitimate, and slower — which is precisely why it is not the one being suggested three days before the cut-off.

5.3 What the Code requires

- [ETH-01 §5.5.1](#) — progress is measured by the rule of credit that applies to the work package, applied consistently, and evidenced.
- [ETH-01 §5.5.2](#) — a certificant must not adopt a more generous basis **because the period is a reporting boundary**, nor apply rules of credit selectively across packages to reach a target percentage.
- [ETH-01 §5.5.3](#) — where measured and claimed progress differ, the difference is reported, not netted away.
- [ETH-01 §4.5](#) and [§7.2](#) — advocacy for your employer's commercial position is legitimate; asserting as fact a quantity that has not been installed is not.
- [ETH-01 §5.4.2](#) — accelerating the recognition of progress across a period boundary to improve a reported position is the mirror image of case two, and is caught by the same clause.

5.4 The options, ranked

1. Claim 71 %, and put the delivered-materials position in front of the counterparty properly. If materials on site are genuinely worth something under the contract, claim them under whatever provision applies to materials — separately, transparently, and with the evidence —

rather than by inflating an erection percentage. This frequently recovers more than the disputed 7 points, and it survives scrutiny.

2. Claim 71 % and propose a rules-of-credit change for future periods. Argue the principle openly and prospectively, with the counterparty's agreement, applied to all packages. Slower; durable; and it removes the temptation permanently.

3. Claim 71 % and disclose the alternative view. State the assessed position and, separately, that a claim of 78 % would follow if credit were given for delivered spools, with the value quantified at CU 840,000. This lets the recipient decide with full information — which is the definition of not misleading them.

4. Claim 78 % with a note about delivered materials. Not acceptable. The figure entering the valuation is the percentage; the note does not travel with it into the ledger, the cash forecast or the earned value.

5. Claim 78 %. A breach of §5.5.2. It is also the one most likely to be found: the erected quantity is physically countable, and a subsequent measure will show either an implausible catch-up or a reversal that someone will have to explain.

5.5 What you actually say

"The rules of credit give thirty for fabrication and fifty for erection measured as erected. On that basis it's seventy-one, and I can evidence every point of it. If we want value for the spools on site, let's claim them as materials on site with the delivery records attached — that's a stronger position than an erection percentage I can't support, and it doesn't put the whole application at risk if they audit the measure. If you want to change the rules of credit for next year, I'll draft it, but I can't apply the change retrospectively to this measure."

Keep the verified measurement sheet. In this case the field engineer's record is the evidence, and it is dated.

— 6. Case five — the caveat that was removed

Fictitious case. Illustrative figures.

6.1 The situation

You are the reporting lead. You issue the monthly controls report for review with a forecast final cost of **CU 54,700,000** and a stated qualification immediately beneath it:

"This forecast excludes the cost effect of the unresolved façade variation, currently assessed at CU 2,300,000, which is not yet instructed. Including it, the forecast would be CU 57,000,000."

$$54,700,000 + 2,300,000 = 57,000,000$$

$$2,300,000 \div 54,700,000 = 0.042 = 4.2 \% \text{ of the reported forecast}$$

The version circulated to the steering group two days later carries the same CU 54,700,000, the same sign-off block with your name in it, and no qualification. Someone has removed the paragraph during formatting. You discover it after the meeting.

6.2 The pressure

There is no pressure in the room, because the room has already happened. The pressure is entirely about what you do now, and it is social rather than commercial: raising it means telling a group of senior people that they were given an incomplete number, embarrassing whoever edited the document, and reopening a meeting that everyone considers closed. The path of least resistance is to fix it quietly in next month's report, where the forecast will "naturally" move to CU 57,000,000 once the variation is instructed.

That path has a specific defect. Next month's report would then show a CU 2,300,000 movement attributed to the variation being instructed — which is not what happened. The movement happened in the document that was edited. Fixing it silently means misstating the reason for a change, which is its own breach of [ETH-01 §5.3](#).

6.3 What the Code requires

- [ETH-01 §5.7.1](#) — an error in issued work is corrected promptly and openly, to everyone who received the original and to anyone known to be relying on it. This applies whether or not you introduced the error.
- [ETH-01 §5.7.2](#) — the correction states what was wrong, what the corrected position is, and what decisions may have been affected. Quietly reissuing a corrected file is not a correction.
- [ETH-01 §5.1.1](#) — you must not knowingly transmit, or allow to stand in your name, something materially misleading. A sign-off block carrying your name is a representation.
- [ETH-01 §7.2](#) — a material misstatement made on your behalf is corrected once you know of it.
- [ETH-01 §5.8](#) — the record of who changed what, and when, is part of the working papers.

Materiality here is a judgement, and it should be made explicitly rather than assumed. CU 2,300,000 is 4.2 % of the reported forecast. Whether that would change a reasonable reader's decision depends on what the steering group was deciding — but the fact that the qualification was drafted at all is strong evidence that you already considered it material when you wrote it.

6.4 The options, ranked

1. Correct it to the same distribution, within a day, in three sentences. State what the issued report omitted, what the position is including the variation, and that no other figure is affected. Short, factual, and no discussion of who edited it — the correction is about the number, not the person.

2. Correct it and fix the mechanism. Same note, plus a change to how the pack is produced: the report is issued as a locked file from the reporting lead, and any edit after sign-off returns to the author. This converts an incident into a control, and it is the version a governance reviewer will respect.

3. Raise it privately with the chair first, then correct to the full distribution. Acceptable where a private word makes the correction land better. It becomes unacceptable the moment the private word is used as a substitute for the correction.

4. Add the qualification to next month's report. Not acceptable. It leaves a decision standing on an incomplete number for a full cycle and misattributes the movement when it appears.

5. Say nothing, and let the variation instruction explain the movement. A breach of §5.7.1 and §5.3. It is also the option with the longest tail: the sign-off block has your name on it, and the version history will show the paragraph was present when you released it and absent when it was circulated.

6.5 What you actually say

To the distribution, in writing, that day:

"The report circulated on the 14th omitted a qualification that was in the version I signed off. The forecast of 54.7 excludes the unresolved façade variation, assessed at 2.3. Including it, the forecast is 57.0. No other figure in the report is affected. I'm sorry for the confusion; the qualification will be on the face of the summary page in future."

To whoever edited it, separately and without an audience:

"The forecast qualification came out of the pack during formatting. I've had to correct it to the distribution because it's a material exclusion. Can we agree that anything after sign-off comes back to me, even for formatting?"

— 7. What the five cases have in common

The pressure was never applied to the truth of a figure. It was applied to a **timing**, a **boundary**, a **basis**, a **constraint** or a **paragraph** — the mechanical joints of a reporting system, all of which are legitimately adjustable and none of which the reader can see.

That is why the general defence "every number in the report is correct" is unavailing, and why [ETH-01 §5.3](#) is written to test the impression created. It is also why the professional response in all five cases has the same three parts:

Separate the number from the narrative. In every case, the honest number and the thing the requester actually wanted could coexist — as a forecast plus a bridge, an index plus an explanation, a date plus a costed compression option, a measure plus a materials claim, a figure plus its qualification. The professional's most useful skill under pressure is finding the presentation that is both honest and useful, because the request usually has a legitimate need buried inside it.

Escalate once, in writing, factually. Not an accusation and not a threat. One paragraph: what I was asked, what I provided, what was agreed. This is the third option practitioners forget exists between silent compliance and resignation, and it is the one [ETH-01 §5.9](#) actually requires.

Keep the record on the day. Measurement sheets, schedule versions, the email you sent, the date. Every case above turns, eventually, on whether there is a contemporaneous record — and a record made three months later, when it matters, is worth almost nothing.

— 8. Three sentences worth having ready

The hardest part of every case above is the first ten seconds, when a reasonable-sounding request needs a response and you have not prepared one. Three sentences cover most of them:

- "I can show that as a scenario with the assumptions named, but I can't put it up as the forecast."
- "Can you confirm that instruction in writing so I can reference it in the working papers?"
- "Here's what I can support, and here's what would have to be true for your number — let's put both in front of them."

None of these is confrontational, all three are usable by a junior person to a senior one, and each one converts a private pressure into a documented decision. That conversion is the whole of the professional obligation in [ETH-01 §5.9](#): not to win, but to make sure the decision is taken by people who can see what they are deciding.

— Related

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) — the clauses cited throughout, especially §5
- [ETH-02 – The principles explained](#) — why the obligations in §5 are drawn where they are
- [ETH-06 – Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions](#) — what happens when escalation inside the organisation does not resolve it
- [BPG-06 – Progress measurement and rules of credit](#) — the method underlying case four
- [BPG-07 – Accruals and cut-off discipline](#) — the method underlying case two
- [BPG-09 – Estimate at completion: choosing and defending a method](#) — the forecasting methods behind cases one and two

— Sources and standards

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) (this framework) — every clause cited.
- PCI Code of Professional Conduct (predecessor instrument), [docs/downloads/code-of-professional-conduct.md](#), repository copy read August 2026.

All five cases are invented for teaching. No external source, survey, project record or organisation is cited, referred to or implied, and none was used. All figures are illustrative and were computed for this document.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.

ETH-04 · CODE OF ETHICS

Conflicts of interest in project controls

Crossing sides, gifts, relationships in the supply chain, and auditing your own estimate

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

How conflicts of interest arise in a project controls function and what to do about each of them: moving between contractor and client, gifts and hospitality, family and personal relationships in a supply chain, and the most common structural conflict of all — acting as both the author and the assurer of the same estimate. Sets out the test the Code applies, what a usable disclosure actually contains, the safeguards that work, the point at which disclosure is not enough, and why the legal position on inducements varies so much between jurisdictions that local advice is not optional.

— About this document

Document	ETH-04
Series	Code of Ethics
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	2

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. The three things people get wrong about conflicts	4
2. The test, and the three states.....	4
3. Moving between contractor and client.....	5
3.1 Confidential information you carry.....	5
3.2 Sitting on the other side of a live matter	5
3.3 The role you are about to take.....	6
4. Gifts, hospitality and inducements.....	6
4.1 What the Code says, and what it does not.....	6
4.2 The three questions that resolve most cases	6
4.3 The legal position varies — and this is the part to take seriously.....	7
5. Family and personal relationships in the supply chain.....	7
5.1 Why this one is under-declared	7
5.2 What to declare	7
5.3 Safeguards that work.....	7
5.4 The recruitment case	8
6. Self-review: the estimator who audits the estimate	8
6.1 The most common structural conflict in this discipline	8
6.2 Why "I was rigorous with myself" is not an answer	8
6.3 What to do when there is genuinely nobody else	8
6.4 The related trap: assurance over a tool you selected.....	9
7. Making a disclosure that is actually usable.....	9
8. When disclosure is not enough	10
9. Conflicts inside the Institute.....	10
10. How this goes wrong.....	10
11. Checklist.....	11
Related	11
Sources and standards.....	12
Status and version	12

Conflicts of interest in project controls

In one paragraph. This document explains how conflicts of interest arise in project controls and what to do about them: moving between contractor and client, gifts and hospitality, family and personal relationships inside a supply chain, and the structural conflict created when the same person prepares and assures the same estimate. It sets out the test the Code applies, what a usable disclosure contains, the safeguards that work and the ones that only look like safeguards, the point at which disclosure is not enough and withdrawal is the only answer, and why the legal treatment of inducements varies so widely between jurisdictions that qualified local advice is a necessary step rather than a cautious one.

Who this is for. Cost engineers, planners, quantity surveyors, estimators, controls managers and heads of function — and the procurement, audit and governance colleagues who have to rely on their independence.

— 1. The three things people get wrong about conflicts

It is not an accusation. Most conflicts arise from ordinary professional life: people change employers, families work in the same industry, small markets have few suppliers, and a good estimator is often the person best placed to review an estimate. Having a conflict says nothing about your character. Failing to declare one says a great deal.

It is not about whether you would actually be influenced. [ETH-01 §12.1](#) sets the test as what a reasonable, informed observer would conclude — not whether you believe yourself to be objective. The reason is structural: assurance has no value if the reader has to take the assessor's self-belief on trust. A conflict damages the usability of your conclusion even when it has not touched your reasoning.

It is not resolved by feeling uncomfortable about it. A conflict is resolved by disclosure to someone who can act, a recorded safeguard, and — where the safeguard is insufficient — withdrawal. Private discomfort is not a control.

There is one further mistake worth naming because it is common among honest, senior people: the belief that declaring a conflict looks weak. In practice a declared interest is an administrative fact that takes ninety seconds to record. An undiscovered one that emerges later is the only thing anyone remembers about the project.

— 2. The test, and the three states

[ETH-01 §12.1](#) covers three states, and they are treated the same way:

State	Meaning	Example
Actual	An interest that is influencing, or could influence, the judgement now	You hold a shareholding in a bidder you are evaluating
Potential	An interest that will become live if something foreseeable happens	You are in advanced discussions about a job with a bidder
Perceived	An interest that a reasonable observer would think capable of influencing the judgement, whether or not it is	Your sibling is a manager at the incumbent supplier, in an unrelated division

All three are disclosed. The difference between them affects the safeguard, not the duty. A perceived conflict frequently needs nothing more than a recorded declaration; an actual one usually needs the person removed from the decision.

Two working questions cut through most cases faster than the categories do:

1. **Would I be comfortable if the person relying on my conclusion learned about this from someone other than me?** If not, disclose it now.
2. **If this decision goes the way my interest points, what will it look like?** Conflicts are judged after the outcome is known, not before.

— 3. Moving between contractor and client

The most common conflict in this discipline, because career progression in project controls routinely crosses the contractual divide. It creates three distinct problems, and they need separating because they have different answers.

3.1 Confidential information you carry

You do not un-learn a former employer's rates, margins, productivity norms, claims strategy or bid position, and [ETH-01 §9.6](#) makes clear that confidentiality survives the employment. The obligation is not to erase your memory; it is not to use or disclose that specific information in the new role.

The distinction that matters — and the one that keeps you employable — is between **capability** and **information**. Your judgement about what a reasonable productivity rate looks like is capability and it travels with you. Your knowledge that a specific former employer prices that activity at a specific rate on a specific job is information and it does not. If you cannot tell which you are drawing on, that in itself is the signal to stop and take advice.

Practical consequences on day one in the new role: bring no documents, no files, no models, no contact-extracted data; do not reconstruct a former employer's rate build-up from memory as a "benchmark"; and do not offer to.

3.2 Sitting on the other side of a live matter

The sharpest case: you move from contractor to client, and the client is in a live commercial dispute with your former employer — one where you personally built the delay analysis or the claim narrative.

Nothing about this is automatically improper, and a blanket rule that people cannot change sides would be both unenforceable and bad for the profession. What is required is disclosure before you touch the matter, and a safeguard proportionate to your involvement. In ascending order of severity: a recorded declaration; exclusion from the specific negotiation while continuing the wider role; a formal information barrier; and, where you were the author of the position now being argued against, complete withdrawal from the matter.

Note also that your new employer's interest and your former employer's interest are both live here, and that your former employer's confidentiality claim does not evaporate because your new employer would find the information useful. That is exactly the pressure [ETH-01 §9.2](#) exists to resist.

3.3 The role you are about to take

A conflict exists from the moment a job discussion becomes real, not from the moment you accept. Evaluating a bid from an organisation you are interviewing with is a live conflict, and it is one that is discovered later with unpleasant regularity, because recruitment leaves a trail.

The rule that works: **the day a conversation about a role becomes a process — an application, an approach you have engaged with, an interview — you declare it and step out of anything touching that organisation.** Waiting until an offer arrives is too late; the decisions you took in between are the ones that will be examined.

Restrictions in an employment contract on where you may go next are a separate matter entirely, they vary enormously between jurisdictions and are not always enforceable — that is a legal question for a qualified adviser in your own jurisdiction, not a professional-conduct question, and this Code does not address it ([ETH-01 §3.3](#)).

— 4. Gifts, hospitality and inducements

4.1 What the Code says, and what it does not

[ETH-01 §12.5](#) prohibits accepting or offering any inducement intended to influence a professional conclusion, a valuation, a certification, an award or a decision, and sets the working standard as: **nothing accepted or offered which you would be unwilling to disclose to the person relying on your judgement.**

The Code deliberately does not set a monetary threshold, and neither should you rely on your employer's threshold as the test. A threshold is a reporting trigger — a useful administrative device that tells you when to write something down. It is not the ethical boundary. A modest gift delivered the week before a tender evaluation is a problem; an expensive but routine industry conference attended by everybody is often not. Timing and specificity matter more than value.

4.2 The three questions that resolve most cases

1. **Timing.** Is there a live decision, evaluation, valuation, claim or renewal in which this party has an interest? If yes, decline — the timing alone creates the perception.
2. **Specificity.** Is this available to the market generally, or is it directed at me? A supplier's technical seminar is different from a supplier's weekend.

3. **Disclosure.** Would I be content for the counterparty to my next commercial decision to see this in a register with my name against it? If not, the answer is already clear.

4.3 The legal position varies — and this is the part to take seriously

Laws on bribery, corruption, facilitation payments and hospitality differ substantially between jurisdictions. Some apply extraterritorially to conduct outside the country where the organisation is based; some create liability for an organisation arising from an employee's act; some treat modest facilitation payments as lawful and others prohibit them absolutely; and public-sector counterparties are frequently subject to rules far stricter than commercial ones. Penalties can be personal as well as corporate.

This Code states a professional standard. It does not state the law of anywhere. Where a gift, payment, commission, agency arrangement, sponsorship or hospitality question has any substance to it, the correct step is advice from a qualified adviser in the relevant jurisdiction and compliance with your organisation's policy — before the thing happens, not after (ETH-01 §3.3.4).

— 5. Family and personal relationships in the supply chain

5.1 Why this one is under-declared

Because it feels intrusive to declare, because the relationship usually predates the project, and because in specialised markets it is unavoidable. A planner whose partner works for the engineering consultancy on the same programme has done nothing wrong, and in a small national market may have no alternative employer.

Under-declaration is nonetheless the common failure, and it converts a manageable fact into a governance incident the day someone else notices.

5.2 What to declare

Declare where a person with whom you have a close personal or financial relationship — partner, family member, household member, close friend, or someone with whom you share a financial interest — is in a position to benefit from, or be affected by, a decision you influence. That includes their employment by a contractor, supplier, bidder or consultant in the chain; their ownership of or material interest in one; and their role in a body that assesses, audits or approves your work.

Declare the relationship and the position. You do not need to disclose the details of your private life, and a well-run register does not ask for them: "my sibling is a project manager at [supplier], in the division supplying the electrical packages" is a complete declaration.

5.3 Safeguards that work

Reallocating the specific decision; excluding you from evaluation panels or valuation approvals touching that party; having a named independent reviewer sign the elements that touch it; and recording all three in the register with a review date. Where you are the head of function and the supplier is material, the honest answer may be that no internal safeguard is sufficient and the review must be done outside the function.

5.4 The recruitment case

Recommending or approving the engagement of a family member, a former colleague or a friend as a contractor or consultant is a conflict in exactly the same way, and is frequently treated as a courtesy rather than a decision. Declare it and remove yourself from the selection and from the subsequent approval of their invoices — the second half is the one people forget.

— 6. Self-review: the estimator who audits the estimate

6.1 The most common structural conflict in this discipline

ETH-01 §12.4 prohibits providing independent assurance over your own work, or over work you directed. In project controls this is breached constantly, and almost never on purpose. It happens because of resourcing: the only person who understands the estimate well enough to review it in the time available is the person who built it.

Recognisable forms:

- preparing an estimate and then performing the estimate review or benchmark check on it;
- writing the controls procedure and then assessing compliance with it;
- owning the forecast and chairing the challenge session on it;
- building the risk model and then providing the assurance opinion on its adequacy;
- producing the monthly report and then conducting the health check that says reporting is effective.

6.2 Why "I was rigorous with myself" is not an answer

Self-review fails for a reason that has nothing to do with honesty. A reviewer's value comes from holding assumptions that the author does not hold. The author's blind spots are, by construction, invisible to the author — which is the entire mechanism by which review adds anything. A rigorous self-review is a better estimate, and it is worth doing; it is not assurance, and reporting it as assurance misdescribes what was performed.

6.3 What to do when there is genuinely nobody else

Small functions have this problem permanently. Four workable answers, in descending order of strength:

1. **Cross-review within the function.** The planner reviews the cost engineer's basis of estimate and vice versa. Not perfect independence, but genuine difference of perspective, and free.
2. **Independence at the level above.** The estimate is reviewed by someone outside the project — a functional head, a peer project, a central estimating group — even if their review is lighter than you would like. Independence with less depth usually beats depth with no independence.
3. **Structured self-challenge, correctly labelled.** Where nobody else exists, perform a documented self-challenge against a defined checklist and **report it as what it is**: "self-review by the author; no independent review performed". That single sentence transfers the risk decision to the person relying on the estimate, where it belongs.

4. **Escalate the gap as a controls finding.** A function that cannot independently review its own principal outputs has a control weakness. Record it in the risk register with an owner rather than absorbing it silently.

Option three is the one worth internalising. The breach in §12.4 is not performing a review of your own work — it is presenting that review as independent.

6.4 The related trap: assurance over a tool you selected

If you chose, championed or configured the reporting or analytics tool, you are not the right person to assure that the data it produces is reliable. This has become sharper as controls functions adopt AI-assisted analysis: the person who introduced the tool has an interest in the answer to "is it working?", and the honest route is the same as above — declare it, get independence where you can, label it where you cannot. See [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#) for the verification obligations that sit alongside this.

— 7. Making a disclosure that is actually usable

Most declarations are useless because they state a fact and stop. A usable disclosure has four parts — what the interest is, how close it is, what it touches, and what you propose.

Illustrative fragment. Fictitious; for structure only.

Field	Entry
Person	Controls manager, Package 4
Interest declared	Sibling is a commercial manager at a company invited to tender for the electrical installation package
Nature and closeness	Immediate family; sibling is employed in the tendering division; no financial interest held by me in the company
What it touches	Tender evaluation for Package 4; subsequent valuation approvals and variation assessment for that package if awarded
Date the interest arose	Pre-existing; became relevant on the date the tender list was issued
Proposed safeguard	I withdraw from tender evaluation and scoring; valuations approved by the senior QS; my involvement limited to schedule integration
Decided by	Project director
Review date	At award, and thereafter at each contract milestone

Three properties make this work. It names the decisions affected rather than the relationship in the abstract. It proposes the safeguard rather than leaving it to someone else to invent under time pressure. And it has a review date, because conflicts change: an interest that was immaterial at tender may be decisive at final account.

Send it in writing, keep a copy, and make sure it reaches someone with the authority to act on it. A disclosure to a peer is a conversation; a disclosure to the decision owner is a control.

— 8. When disclosure is not enough

Disclosure manages a conflict. It does not neutralise one. [ETH-01 §12.3](#) requires withdrawal where the conflict cannot be managed, and the cases where that is so are reasonably clear:

- where you have a **direct financial interest** in an outcome you influence — a shareholding, a commission, a success fee, an interest in a bidder;
- where you would be **assuring your own work**, and no independent alternative can be arranged (§6.3 option three is the fallback, not a permission);
- where you hold **confidential information from one party** whose use would benefit another party you now serve;
- where you are being asked to act **for two parties whose interests genuinely oppose** on the matter in question;
- where the perception alone would **destroy the usefulness** of the conclusion — an assurance opinion that no reader will credit is not worth issuing.

Withdrawal is stated plainly and early: "I'm declaring an interest in this and standing out of the evaluation. Here is what I can still do." The second sentence matters. Withdrawal from a decision is not withdrawal from the job, and framing it precisely keeps the function working.

Where a conflict cannot be managed and the organisation nonetheless requires you to act, that is no longer a conflicts question — it is [ETH-01 §5.9](#), escalate and record.

— 9. Conflicts inside the Institute

The Institute is subject to the same discipline it imposes, and says so. Examiners, item writers, subject-matter experts, committee members and reviewers hold interests too — as employers of candidates, as training providers, as consultants to organisations seeking certification. The Institute's arrangements for managing that are governed under the Certification & Impartiality Committee.

[CONFIRM: whether PCI maintains a declarable-interest register for committee members, examiners, item writers and subject-matter experts, and the threshold and review cycle for declarations]

[CONFIRM: whether a certificant must notify PCI of a conflict of interest they were unable to manage, and in what circumstances]

Two points do not depend on those confirmations. PCI owns the standard and the examination; the Institute's official preparation and training partner is a separate organisation, and the two are never blurred. And a person who assesses a candidate they have trained, employed or supervised has a conflict of exactly the kind described in §6 — the remedy is the same.

— 10. How this goes wrong

The declaration nobody reads. An interest recorded in a register that is never reviewed, with no safeguard attached and no review date, is filing rather than managing. The test of a register is whether anything ever changes as a result of an entry.

Declaring late. After the evaluation, after the award, after the valuation. The disclosure obligation attaches before the judgement is exercised ([ETH-01 §12.2.1](#)) — a declaration made after the decision protects nobody, least of all you.

Treating the threshold as the ethics. "It was under the limit" answers the wrong question. See §4.1.

Managing the obvious conflict and missing the structural one. Functions police gifts assiduously and then let the same person build and assure the estimate every month. The second one affects more decisions.

Assuming seniority is a safeguard. The more senior the person, the fewer people are able to challenge their judgement — which makes their conflicts more consequential, not less.

Confusing a conflict with a disagreement. Someone reaching a conclusion you dislike is not evidence of a conflict, and alleging one is a serious matter. If you believe a conflict exists, raise the interest and the decisions it touches; do not raise the conclusion you disagree with.

— 11. Checklist

Use before an evaluation, a valuation, an audit, an assurance opinion, or any decision touching a supplier.

- [] Do I, or does someone close to me, have any financial interest in any party to this decision?
- [] Have I worked for, been engaged by, or discussed a role with any party in the last two years? (Two years is a working convention, not a rule — use your own organisation's period if it has one.)
- [] Does anyone close to me work for, own part of, or benefit from any party here?
- [] Am I about to review, assure or approve something I produced or directed?
- [] Have I received anything from any party — gift, hospitality, sponsorship, travel, a favour — in a period where a live decision existed?
- [] Do I hold confidential information from one party that this role would tempt me to use?
- [] Would I be comfortable if every party to this decision saw my answers to the above?
- [] If I answered yes to any of these: is it declared, in writing, to someone who can act, with a proposed safeguard and a review date?

A conflict that is declared, safeguarded and reviewed is a routine administrative fact. The same conflict, undeclared, is the reason a competent professional's judgement stops being usable — and it is the reader's loss before it is ever the professional's.

— Related

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) — §12 states the binding obligations this document explains
- [ETH-02 – The principles explained](#) — the reasoning behind the perception test in §4.4

- [ETH-06 – Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions](#) — the route when a conflict is being ignored
- [BPG-19 – Project controls assurance and health checks](#) — how to build independence into a review programme

— Sources and standards

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) (this framework) — §9, §12 and §3.3.
- PCI Code of Professional Conduct (predecessor instrument), [docs/downloads/code-of-professional-conduct.md](#), repository copy read August 2026 — Principle 4 and Principle 3.

No external legal source is cited, and none should be inferred. The statements about variation in bribery, corruption and employment-restriction law are general observations that a qualified adviser in the relevant jurisdiction can confirm for the reader's circumstances; this document is not legal advice.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.

ETH-05 · CODE OF ETHICS

The ethical use of AI and data

Confidentiality, ownership and the duty to explain a number
you submitted

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT

2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.

AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The conduct obligations that attach to AI-assisted project controls work: keeping commercially sensitive and personal project data out of systems the data owner does not control, understanding who owns work an AI tool helped produce, and being able to explain — in your own words, without the tool open — any number you submitted under your name. Sets out the verification standard, what a material AI contribution is and how to disclose it, the short record that makes AI-assisted work defensible months later, and the deskilling risk that no policy can control for you.

— About this document

Document	ETH-05
Series	Code of Ethics
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	2

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. What the Institute's rule actually allocates	4
2. The duty to explain a number you submitted.....	5
2.1 The obligation	5
2.2 The four-question test.....	5
2.3 Verification is proportionate, not uniform	5
3. Confidential data and AI tools.....	6
3.1 What actually leaves when you paste	6
3.2 What counts as confidential in this discipline	6
3.3 Anonymisation is harder than it looks	6
3.4 The practical test, and the honest follow-up.....	7
3.5 The organisational answer.....	7
4. Who owns work an AI tool helped produce	7
4.1 The legal question — which varies, and is not ours to answer	7
4.2 The contractual question — which is usually answerable today.....	7
4.3 The professional question — which does not vary at all	8
5. Disclosing a material AI contribution.....	8
5.1 When disclosure is required.....	8
5.2 What disclosure looks like	8
5.3 The AI-assist record.....	8
5.4 Disclosure to the Institute	9
6. Personal data, and analytics that affect people	9
7. Deskillling — the obligation no policy can enforce.....	10
8. AI, the Institute and the examination.....	10
9. How this goes wrong	10
10. Two checklists.....	11
Related	11
Sources and standards.....	12
Status and version	12

The ethical use of AI and data

In one paragraph. This document sets out the conduct obligations that attach to AI-assisted project controls work: keeping commercially sensitive and personal project data out of systems the data owner does not control, understanding who owns work an AI tool helped produce, and being able to explain — in your own words, without the tool open — any number you submitted under your name. It covers the verification standard, what counts as a material AI contribution and how to disclose it, the short record that makes AI-assisted work defensible months later, the handling of personal data in analytics that affect people, and the deskilling risk that no policy can control on your behalf.

Who this is for. Practising cost engineers, planners, estimators and controls managers using AI tools in live work, and the managers who sign off what those tools help produce.

— 1. What the Institute's rule actually allocates

AI proposes; the professional disposes is frequently read as a statement about how much automation is appropriate. It is not. It is a statement about **where accountability sits**, and it settles one question only: when an AI-assisted output turns out to be wrong, the answer to who is answerable is the named human, every time.

That allocation is invariant. It does not shift with the sophistication of the tool, the vendor's assurances, the organisation's procurement decision, or the fact that everyone in the market uses the same product. [ETH-01 §10.6](#) puts it plainly: output carrying a certificant's name is theirs, whatever produced it.

Three consequences follow, and the rest of this document is those three consequences in detail.

1. You are accountable for what you put **into** the tool — which makes confidentiality a first-order obligation rather than an IT policy (§3).
2. You are accountable for what comes **out** of it — which makes verification and the ability to explain a professional duty rather than a courtesy (§2).
3. You are accountable for **how it is understood** — which makes disclosure of a material AI contribution part of not misleading the reader (§5).

What this document does not cover. The technical governance of AI in a controls function — model selection, data readiness, bias testing, auditability, the design of human-in-the-loop controls — is owned by the S02 series and is not restated here. See [AIG-08 – Governing AI on a project](#), [AIG-09 – Bias, explainability and auditability](#) and [AIG-10 – Human in the loop](#). This document covers what the individual must do, and what happens to their standing if they do not.

— 2. The duty to explain a number you submitted

2.1 The obligation

ETH-01 §10.3 requires a certificant to be able to explain, in their own words and without the tool in front of them, what a submitted number rests on, how it was produced and why it holds. Inability to do so is itself a breach — independently of whether the number is right.

That last clause is the one people argue with, so it is worth stating the reasoning. A number you cannot explain is a number you cannot defend, cannot correct, cannot sensitise and cannot withdraw. It is also a number you cannot tell is wrong, which means the review step everyone assumes has happened has not happened. Correctness that you cannot demonstrate is indistinguishable, to the person relying on it, from luck.

2.2 The four-question test

Before a number leaves you, answer all four without opening anything:

1. **What data does it rest on?** Which source, as at what date, covering what scope, with what known gaps.
2. **What method produced it?** Not the product name — the method. "A cost-performance-index-based extrapolation of remaining work" is a method; "the forecasting module" is a brand.
3. **Which assumption drives it?** The one input that, if wrong, changes the answer most.
4. **What would have to be true for it to be wrong?** If you cannot name a failure mode, you have not understood the output well enough to submit it.

A practitioner who can answer these four is the author of the number regardless of what produced the first draft. One who cannot is transmitting, and ETH-01 §5.1.1 prohibits knowingly transmitting something you cannot stand behind.

2.3 Verification is proportionate, not uniform

ETH-01 §10.2 sets the depth of check by the consequence of being wrong. A drafting suggestion for a narrative paragraph needs a read. A completion forecast feeding a funding decision needs an independent recomputation by a different method.

Illustrative figures. Fictitious example, for method only.

An AI-assisted forecasting tool proposes an estimate at completion of **CU 87,300,000**. The independent check uses a different method — a cumulative cost performance index extrapolation — on the same reported data:

```
BAC = 82,000,000      EV = 30,000,000      AC = 32,400,000
CPI = EV ÷ AC = 30,000,000 ÷ 32,400,000 = 0.926
EAC = BAC ÷ CPI = 82,000,000 × (32,400,000 ÷ 30,000,000) = 82,000,000 × 1.08 = 88,560,000
Difference = 88,560,000 - 87,300,000 = 1,260,000
1,260,000 ÷ 82,000,000 = 0.015 = 1.5 % of budget at completion
```

Assumption stated with the answer: the index method assumes remaining work performs at the cumulative index to date, which is one defensible assumption among several.

The check has not failed. Two methods differing by 1.5 % of budget is unremarkable. **The verification is complete only when you can say why they differ** — for example, that the tool weights recent periods more heavily than the cumulative index does, and that recent performance has improved. If you cannot account for the gap, you have found something, and the correct response is to investigate rather than to pick the more convenient figure.

That last sentence is where verification most often fails in practice. Choosing between two numbers on grounds of preference, having generated both, is [ETH-01 §5.1.3](#) — starting from the answer — with extra steps.

— 3. Confidential data and AI tools

3.1 What actually leaves when you paste

[ETH-01 §10.5](#) prohibits entering confidential project, commercial or personal data into an AI tool outside the data owner's control and policies. The obligation exists because pasting is a **disclosure**, and disclosure without authority breaches [ETH-01 §9.2](#) whether or not anything adverse follows.

Treat the following as unresolved unless your organisation has established otherwise for the specific tool and the specific account: whether inputs are retained, for how long, and where; whether they are used to improve the service; who inside the provider can access them; whether they are processed in a jurisdiction your client's contract permits; and what happens to them if the provider is acquired or fails. These are not paranoid questions — they are the questions your client's confidentiality clause already asks of you, and the answers vary by product, by plan tier and by configuration.

3.2 What counts as confidential in this discipline

More than people assume. Rates and rate build-ups; margin and mark-up; productivity norms; bid and tender positions; claims strategy and delay analysis; unpriced variations; contract terms; supply-chain pricing; resource histograms detailed enough to reveal commercial capacity; and any personal data at all. Also: the existence of certain things — that a project is in dispute, that a package is being re-tendered, that a forecast has moved — which can be commercially significant on its own.

3.3 Anonymisation is harder than it looks

Removing the client's name is not anonymisation. Project controls data is unusually identifying, because the detail that makes it useful is the detail that makes it traceable: a scope description, a country, a start year, a contract value and a package structure will frequently identify a project to anyone in that market.

The working test in [ETH-01 §10.5](#) is residual: **where what remains would still identify the project, the party or the person to a knowledgeable reader, it is still confidential**. If you need AI help with a method, reconstruct the problem with invented figures at a plausible scale — which is also what the Institute's candidate policy requires of people studying.

3.4 The practical test, and the honest follow-up

The test the Institute uses, and it works: **would you be comfortable if the data owner watched you do it?**

If the answer arrives slowly, do not paste. If you have already pasted something you should not have, the obligation is [ETH-01 §5.7](#) applied to a disclosure rather than a number: tell whoever owns the data and whoever owns the incident process in your organisation, promptly, with what was disclosed and when. This is uncomfortable and it is much less costly than the alternative, which is the same conversation later with an additional question about why you did not raise it.

3.5 The organisational answer

Individual restraint is not a control. Where a controls function relies on AI, someone must decide which tools are approved, on what account terms, with what data classification, and with what enforcement — and that decision belongs to the organisation, not to each practitioner at the moment of temptation. Where no such decision exists, raising the gap is itself a professional act ([ETH-01 §5.9](#)), and it is one of the more useful things a controls manager can put in front of a governance board this year.

— 4. Who owns work an AI tool helped produce

Three separate questions get collapsed into one, and separating them resolves most of the confusion.

4.1 The legal question — which varies, and is not ours to answer

Whether, and to what extent, material generated with substantial AI assistance attracts copyright or similar protection, and who owns it if it does, is a matter of national law. Treatment differs between jurisdictions, the position is developing, and outcomes can turn on how much human authorship went into the result. **This document does not state the law of anywhere** ([ETH-01 §3.3](#)). Where ownership of a deliverable actually matters — a model, a database, a report you intend to license or reuse — take advice from a qualified adviser in the relevant jurisdiction.

4.2 The contractual question — which is usually answerable today

Two contracts govern, and both are readable this afternoon:

- **The vendor's terms**, which state what rights you have in outputs, what rights the provider takes in inputs, and what the provider may do with either.
- **Your client or employer contract**, which typically assigns intellectual property in deliverables, may restrict subcontracting or processing by third parties, may require disclosure of tools used, and may prohibit transferring data outside defined boundaries.

The second frequently constrains the first. A client contract requiring that deliverables be produced by named personnel, or prohibiting disclosure to third parties without consent, has something to say about a tool that processes the deliverable — and it said it before AI was in scope.

4.3 The professional question — which does not vary at all

Whatever the law says and whatever the vendor's terms say, [ETH-01 §10.6](#) fixes the position for the purposes of this Code: **the named human owns the output professionally**. Accountability is not transferred by the vendor's disclaimer, not shared with the model, and not reduced by the tool's limitations.

This has a practical edge that catches people out. If you cannot establish that you are entitled to use the output — because the vendor's terms restrict it, or because your client's contract does — you must not submit it as a deliverable. "I did not read the terms" is the same defence as "the model said so", and [ETH-01 §10.3](#) has already disposed of it.

— 5. Disclosing a material AI contribution

5.1 When disclosure is required

[ETH-01 §10.4](#) requires the contribution to be visible where it is **material to the conclusion** — that is, where a reviewer's assessment of the output would change if they knew. Working line:

Usually not material	Usually material
Drafting or tidying narrative you then rewrote	A forecast, range or probability the tool generated
Formatting, summarising your own text	A risk score, classification or ranking driven by a model
Explaining a method to you before you applied it	A quantity, rate or allowance derived from a model's inference
Searching your own documents	Anything you could not reproduce by another route

The distinguishing question is not how much the tool did. It is whether the reader, knowing, would scrutinise the output differently.

5.2 What disclosure looks like

A sentence in the basis of estimate or the report's method note. Not a legal disclaimer, not a banner, and not an apology:

"Draft duration ranges were generated by an AI-assisted analysis of the historical package data listed in Appendix B, and were reviewed and adjusted by the planning lead; the correlation assumptions are the planning lead's judgement."

That sentence tells a reviewer exactly where to look — which is the entire purpose.

5.3 The AI-assist record

[ETH-01 §10.7](#) requires a short record where AI materially contributed to a submitted output. It is four fields and it takes a minute:

Field	Content
Tool and version	What was used, and its configuration if it matters
Inputs supplied	What data went in — and confirmation that it was permitted to go in
Check performed	The independent verification, its method, and its result
Named owner	The person accountable for the output, and the date

The value of this record is entirely in the future. Nine months later, when a forecast is being examined in a dispute, an audit or an appeal, the difference between a professional who can produce this and one who cannot is the difference between an explanation and an argument.

5.4 Disclosure to the Institute

[CONFIRM: whether PCI requires an AI-assistance declaration on CPD evidence, application evidence and appeal submissions, and in what form]

The obligation that does not depend on that confirmation is [ETH-01 §11.1](#): everything said to the Institute must be true and complete, and evidence must be genuine. Evidence of professional work that you did not perform is not evidence of your competence, whatever produced it.

— 6. Personal data, and analytics that affect people

Project controls increasingly touches data about people: timesheets, productivity by crew, competence records, absence, access logs, and — in the examination context — proctoring material. Three obligations apply, and they are easy to state and easy to overlook.

Purpose. Data gathered to control a project is used to control the project. Repurposing productivity data into an assessment of named individuals is a new purpose, and it requires authority ([ETH-01 §9.2](#)).

Proportionality. The question is not whether an analysis is technically possible but whether the intrusion is proportionate to the control objective. Crew-level productivity analysis is normal project controls; individual-level behavioural inference from the same data is a different activity with different obligations.

Consequence. Where an analysis will affect a person's standing, pay or employment, a human must be able to explain the basis of the conclusion to the person affected — which is [ETH-01 §10.3](#) with the stakes raised. An adverse inference no one can explain should not be acted on.

The applicable data-protection framework differs by jurisdiction and, frequently, by the location of the workforce rather than the head office. [ETH-01 §9.4](#) requires compliance with the framework that applies; determining which one that is, in a multinational supply chain, is a question for your organisation's data-protection function, not for the practitioner alone.

— 7. Deskilling — the obligation no policy can enforce

ETH-01 §8.3 requires competence to be maintained. AI creates a specific and slow-moving threat to it: a practitioner who has never performed the calculation cannot sense when the output is wrong, and sensing that is most of what experience consists of.

This is a genuine conduct matter and not a nostalgic one, because it feeds directly back into §2. The four-question test in §2.2 is only answerable by someone who understands the method. A practitioner who has always had the method performed for them will pass the test by reciting the tool's description of itself — which is exactly the failure the test was written to catch.

Two habits hold the line, and both are cheap. Perform the core calculations of your discipline by hand or in a plain spreadsheet often enough that the method stays yours — not as a purity exercise but as calibration. And when a tool gives you an answer, form your own expectation of the answer before you look at it. Estimating first is what turns tool use into judgement rather than acceptance.

The Institute's position on study is the same and is set out in the Candidate AI-Use Policy: use AI to check and to explain, not to substitute; if the AI did the thinking, you have not learned it.

— 8. AI, the Institute and the examination

Three settings, one principle, different rules — and the difference is a frequent source of honest confusion, so it is stated plainly.

Setting	Position
Preparation	Encouraged, with honest-learning cautions and no confidential data
Examination	Prohibited, in any form, however obtained (ETH-01 §11.2.3)
Professional practice	Governed — verified, explainable, disclosed where material, owned

The examination prohibition does not rest on detection, and the Institute does not claim that invigilation technology catches everything. It rests on what the credential is for: a pass obtained with a tool's help would certify the tool.

[CONFIRM: whether the Institute's AI standard is published as a separate policy document, and its exact title, so that this document can cite it rather than describe it]

— 9. How this goes wrong

Pasting first, thinking second. The single most common breach in this area, and the one with the least deliberation behind it. It takes four seconds and cannot be undone.

Verifying against the same source. Checking an AI-produced forecast using the same tool, the same data and the same method verifies nothing. Independence of method is the whole point.

Accepting the confident answer. Fluency is not accuracy. AI-generated project controls content is frequently plausible and specifically wrong — a formula misremembered, a term misapplied, a standard misdescribed — and the confident register makes it harder to catch, not easier.

Disclosing everything, so that disclosure means nothing. A blanket "AI tools may have been used" on every document tells a reviewer nothing and buys no credit. Disclose where it is material and say where.

Treating the vendor's assurance as your verification. A supplier's statement that a model is accurate is a commercial position. [ETH-01 §10.2](#) requires your check.

Assuming the organisation has decided. Many practitioners assume an approved-tools position exists somewhere. Where none does, the practitioner is making the policy — one paste at a time.

— 10. Two checklists

Before you put anything in.

- ☐ Is this data confidential, personal, or commercially significant by its existence alone?
- ☐ Is this tool approved by my organisation for this classification of data?
- ☐ Do I know whether inputs are retained, and where they are processed?
- ☐ Does the client contract permit processing by a third party?
- ☐ If I have removed names, would a knowledgeable reader still identify the project or person?
- ☐ Would I be comfortable if the data owner watched me do this?

Before you submit anything out.

- ☐ Can I state the data, the method, the driving assumption and the failure mode without opening the tool?
- ☐ Have I verified by an independent method, proportionate to the consequence of being wrong?
- ☐ Can I explain any difference between the two results?
- ☐ Is the AI contribution material — and if so, is it visible where a reviewer will find it?
- ☐ Have I recorded tool, inputs, check and owner?
- ☐ Am I entitled to use this output as a deliverable under the vendor's terms and my client's contract?

The last question in each list is the one people skip, and both of them are the ones that surface nine months later — when the forecast is being examined by someone who was not in the room and has only the record to go on.

— Related

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) — §10 states the binding obligations this document explains
- [ETH-02 – The principles explained](#) — the reasoning behind the governed-AI principle
- [AIG-08 – Governing AI on a project: the control framework](#) — the organisational controls this document assumes exist
- [AIG-09 – Bias, explainability and auditability](#) — the technical treatment of explainability

- [AIG-10 – Human in the loop: what AI may and may not decide](#) — where the decision boundary is drawn

— Sources and standards

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) (this framework) — §9, §10 and §11.2.3.
- PCI Candidate AI-Use Policy, [docs/downloads/candidate-ai-use-policy.md](#), repository copy read August 2026 — the three settings in §8, the study cautions in §7, and the data-privacy test in §3.4.
- PCI Code of Professional Conduct (predecessor instrument), [docs/downloads/code-of-professional-conduct.md](#), repository copy read August 2026 — Principle 8.

No external standard, vendor document, statute or study is cited, and none should be inferred. The statements about variation in copyright and data-protection law are general observations for which a qualified adviser in the relevant jurisdiction is the correct source; this document is not legal advice. The worked example in §2.3 is illustrative and was computed for this document.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.

ETH-06 · CODE OF ETHICS

Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions

The routes, the protections and their limits, the investigation, and the range of outcomes

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT

2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.

AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

How a concern about the conduct of a PCI candidate or certificant is raised and handled: which of the three routes applies, how to raise a concern inside your own organisation first and when to bring it to the Institute, what a usable report contains, how an investigation runs and what fair process guarantees, the range of outcomes available and their limits, the appeal to the Appeals Panel, and — stated plainly — what protection the Institute can offer a person who raises a concern and what it cannot, because legal protection against retaliation is a matter of local law and varies enormously.

— About this document

Document	ETH-06
Series	Code of Ethics
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	13

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. Three different things, three different routes	5
2. Raise it inside your organisation first — ordinarily	6
2.1 The default	6
2.2 How to raise it internally so that it registers	6
2.3 When to come to the Institute instead of, or as well as	6
3. Raising a concern with the Institute	6
3.1 Who may raise one	6
3.2 What a usable report contains	7
3.3 Anonymous reports	7
3.4 Confidentiality and the evidence you send	7
3.5 Good faith, and the limits of it	7
4. Triage — what happens first	8
5. Investigation	8
5.1 Principles	8
5.2 What the person concerned is entitled to	8
5.3 What the person concerned must do	8
5.4 What is gathered	9
5.5 Interim measures	9
6. Decision	9
6.1 Who decides	9
6.2 The standard applied	9
6.3 What is decided	9
6.4 Reasons	9
7. Outcomes	10
7.1 The range	10
7.2 No tariff is stated, and none should be inferred	10
7.3 What is weighed	10
7.4 Publication	10
7.5 What the Institute cannot do	10
8. Effect on results and credentials	11
9. Appeals	11
9.1 The right	11
9.2 Independence	11
9.3 Grounds, time limits and fees	11
9.4 What an appeal is not	11
10. Protection from detriment — what is ours to give, and what is not	12
10.1 What the Institute undertakes	12
10.2 What the Institute cannot do — and this matters more	12
10.3 The legal position varies, and no professional body can tell you what it is	12
10.4 What is nonetheless worth knowing	12

11. Complaints about the Institute	13
12. Records and privacy of case material.....	13
13. If a concern is raised about you	13
14. Checklist — before you raise a concern	14
Related	14
Sources and standards.....	14
Status and version	15

Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions

In one paragraph. This document sets out how a concern about the conduct of a PCI candidate or certificant is raised and handled: which of three distinct routes applies, when to raise a matter inside your own organisation first and when to bring it to the Institute, what a usable report contains, how an investigation runs and what fair process guarantees the person concerned, the range of outcomes available and their limits, and the appeal that follows an adverse decision. It also states plainly what protection the Institute can offer someone who raises a concern and what it cannot — because protection against retaliation by an employer is a matter of local law, it varies enormously between countries and employment arrangements, and no professional body can confer it.

Who this is for. Anyone considering raising a concern about a PCI candidate or certificant; anyone who is the subject of one; and the employers, sponsors and clients who need to know that the credential means something after it has been awarded.

— 1. Three different things, three different routes

The most common failure in this area is procedural: a person with a genuine matter sends it down the wrong route, and the delay is read as indifference. Three things are routinely conflated.

What it is	Route	Decided by
A concern about a person's conduct — a candidate or certificant is alleged to have breached the Code	Conduct concern (\$3–\$4)	The body designated to determine conduct cases (§6.1)
An appeal against a decision affecting you — eligibility, result, invalidation, certification, or a conduct outcome	Appeal (\$9)	The Appeals Panel, independent of the original decision
A complaint about the Institute — its service, its process, its staff, its systems	Complaint (\$11)	The Institute's complaints route, with impartiality overseen by the Certification & Impartiality Committee

They are deliberately separated so that each decision is made by the right people, and so that no one reviews their own decision.

The Institute's platform records four case types raised by a candidate or certificant through their portal — a **result appeal**, an **invalidation appeal**, a **complaint**, and an **ethics concern** — each moving through the states submitted, under review, and then upheld or dismissed, with supporting evidence attachable to the case and the decision returned through the portal. A concern about someone else's conduct is the ethics route.

[CONFIRM: the published address and web route for raising a conduct concern with PCI by a person who does not hold a portal account]

— 2. Raise it inside your organisation first — ordinarily

2.1 The default

ETH-01 §13.1 expects a concern about conduct to be raised first within the organisation where it arises: line management, project governance, internal audit, or an ethics or compliance route.

This is not deference. It is that the organisation is usually the only body able to fix the thing — correct the report, revise the forecast, re-measure the package, stop the payment. The Institute can act on a person's certification. It cannot correct a project's numbers, direct an employer, recover a loss or award compensation.

2.2 How to raise it internally so that it registers

- **In writing, factually, once.** One paragraph: what you were asked or what you observed, when, by whom, and what you believe is wrong with it. No adjectives.
- **To someone with authority to act**, not to a peer. A concern raised sideways is a conversation.
- **Keep your own copy**, dated, stored somewhere that survives losing access to a system.
- **Say what you want to happen.** "I am asking that the report is not issued until the qualification is reinstated" is actionable; "I am uncomfortable with this" is not.

2.3 When to come to the Institute instead of, or as well as

Ordinarily after the internal route is exhausted or has failed. But go directly where:

- the internal route is compromised — the conduct concerns the people who own it;
- the matter is examination or certification misconduct, which only the Institute can address (impersonation, item disclosure, false eligibility evidence, fraudulent use of a designation);
- there is a risk to safety or a clear public interest that internal escalation is not addressing;
- you no longer work there, and internal escalation is no longer open to you.

[CONFIRM: whether a time limit applies to raising a concern about historic conduct, and any discretion to accept a late report]

— 3. Raising a concern with the Institute

3.1 Who may raise one

Anyone. ETH-01 §13.2 places no restriction: a colleague, a manager, an employer, a client, a competitor, a member of the public, another certificant, or the Institute itself acting on information it holds. You do not need to be affected by the conduct, and you do not need to hold a PCI credential.

3.2 What a usable report contains

A report the Institute can act on says:

1. **Who** — the person concerned, and enough to identify them (name, and where known their credential or the fact they are a candidate).
2. **What** — what they are said to have done, factually, without characterisation.
3. **When and where** — dates, the project or engagement, the role they held.
4. **How you know** — direct observation, a document, something you were told and by whom.
5. **What evidence exists** — and, critically, what evidence you may lawfully and properly provide. See §3.4.
6. **What has already happened** — whether it was raised internally, and with what result.
7. **Your contact details**, and whether you are content to be identified to the person concerned.

Reports that assert a conclusion without the underlying facts are the hardest to progress, because the first step of any investigation is to establish what happened.

3.3 Anonymous reports

[CONFIRM: whether PCI accepts anonymous conduct reports, how they are triaged, and what weight is given to a report that cannot be tested with the reporter]

Two things are true independently of that confirmation. An anonymous report is harder to investigate, because material questions cannot be put back to the source and fairness to the person concerned requires that the allegation be capable of being tested. And an anonymous report of something independently verifiable — a document, a published claim, a designation used by someone who does not hold it — can be perfectly actionable.

3.4 Confidentiality and the evidence you send

Raising a concern does not suspend your own obligations. [ETH-01 §9](#) continues to apply to the material you hold, which means:

- send what is necessary to explain the concern, not everything you have;
- redact third-party personal data you do not need to include;
- do not remove confidential documents from an employer's systems in order to support a report without considering your obligations and, where the matter is significant, taking advice ([ETH-01 §3.3.4](#));
- where you cannot properly provide the underlying document, say what it is and where it is held. The Institute can often obtain it through the person concerned or their employer.

The Institute treats case material as confidential and shares it only as fair process requires — which does include sharing the substance of an allegation with the person it concerns (§5.2).

3.5 Good faith, and the limits of it

[ETH-01 §13.3](#): a person who raises a concern honestly and on reasonable grounds is not in breach because the concern is not upheld. You are not required to be right. You are required to be honest.

Raising a concern you know to be false, or raising one to harass a colleague, damage a competitor or gain advantage in a commercial dispute, is itself a breach of the Code by a certificant and will be treated as one.

— 4. Triage — what happens first

4.1 The report is acknowledged and recorded.

4.2 It is assessed against three questions: is the person within the Institute's jurisdiction (ETH-01 §2); does the conduct described, if established, amount to a breach; and is there enough to investigate.

4.3 One of four things follows: no further action, with reasons given to the reporter; a request for further information; referral to another route (an appeal or a complaint about the Institute); or the opening of an investigation.

4.4 Where the matter is more properly one for an employer, a regulator or a law-enforcement authority, the Institute may say so — and may still investigate the professional-conduct aspect in parallel, since the questions are different.

[CONFIRM: the target time to acknowledge a conduct report, to complete triage, and to conclude an investigation, and how the parties are kept informed of progress]

— 5. Investigation

5.1 Principles

An investigation establishes facts. It is not a prosecution and it does not begin from the assumption that the report is correct. It is conducted by people with no conflict of interest in the matter (ETH-01 §14.3) — which, in a small professional community, is a real constraint that must be managed rather than assumed away.

5.2 What the person concerned is entitled to

- To be told that a concern has been raised, what is alleged, and on what evidence.
- A genuine opportunity to respond, with time proportionate to the complexity of the matter.
- To see the material relied on, subject to the protection of third parties.
- To be accompanied or supported where they are interviewed [CONFIRM: whether a person may be accompanied at an investigation interview, and by whom].
- To have their response recorded and considered.
- A decision with reasons, and a right of appeal (§9).

5.3 What the person concerned must do

ETH-01 §11.4.1 requires cooperation: answering truthfully, and not destroying, altering or withholding relevant records. Non-cooperation is itself a conduct matter, and it is one the Institute takes seriously precisely because the alternative is that the process can be defeated by silence.

Cooperation does not require self-incrimination in another forum. Where a matter is also the subject of legal or regulatory proceedings, say so — timing can usually be managed, and this is a point on which to take your own advice.

5.4 What is gathered

Documents, system records, correspondence, the accounts of people with direct knowledge, and the person's own response. In this discipline the decisive evidence is usually contemporaneous and mundane: a dated measurement sheet, a schedule version, an email sent the same afternoon. This is why [ETH-01 §5.8](#) requires records to be kept — the record protects the professional at least as often as it exposes one.

5.5 Interim measures

[CONFIRM: whether PCI may impose an interim suspension of a credential or of examination eligibility while an investigation is in progress, on whose authority, on what test, and with what right of review]

— 6. Decision

6.1 Who decides

[CONFIRM: which PCI body determines conduct cases at first instance, how its members are appointed, and its relationship to the Certification & Impartiality Committee]

What is settled is the principle: the decision is taken by people independent of the investigation and free of conflicts in the matter, and it is recorded with reasons. The Certification & Impartiality Committee exists in PCI's governance to safeguard exactly that independence.

6.2 The standard applied

[CONFIRM: the standard of proof applied in a conduct determination, and whether it varies with the seriousness of the allegation]

6.3 What is decided

Two questions, separately: whether the conduct occurred, and whether it breached the Code. They are separate because conduct can be established and still fall short of a breach — a professional disagreement about method, a mistake corrected properly, an escalation that was overruled by people entitled to overrule it ([ETH-01 §6.4](#)).

6.4 Reasons

The decision states what was found, what clause was breached, what was taken into account, and what follows. A decision without reasons cannot be appealed intelligibly, which is why reasons are part of fair process rather than a courtesy.

— 7. Outcomes

7.1 The range

ETH-01 §14.4 sets the range as proportionate, running from guidance and a recorded warning, through conditions on continued certification, to suspension and — in serious cases — withdrawal of certification. Where the conduct concerns an examination, an outcome may also include invalidation of a result and loss of the right to resit.

7.2 No tariff is stated, and none should be inferred

[CONFIRM: the published sanction range and any tariff mapping breach categories to outcomes, including the minimum period before a person whose certification has been withdrawn may reapply, and any conditions on reapplication]

The Institute would rather publish nothing than publish a schedule of sanctions it has not adopted. Where a document in this framework could have invented a number, it does not.

7.3 What is weighed

ETH-01 §14.2 lists the factors: whether the conduct was deliberate, reckless or careless; its materiality and who was exposed to it; concealment; repetition; the person's seniority and the reliance placed on them; self-reporting and correction; cooperation; the pressure the person was under, which may mitigate but does not excuse; and any previous finding.

Two of those deserve emphasis because they change outcomes most often. **Concealment** consistently weighs heavier than the original conduct — a corrected error is a professional act, a concealed one is a second breach. And **self-reporting** is genuinely mitigating: a person who brings their own error forward is demonstrating the thing the Code exists to protect.

7.4 Publication

[CONFIRM: whether conduct outcomes are published, in what form, with or without identification of the person, and for how long]

Whatever is decided, the register of who currently holds a valid credential is the Institute's answer to the question an employer actually asks, and verification of a credential is available independently of any conduct history.

7.5 What the Institute cannot do

Stated plainly, because expectations otherwise attach to the wrong body. The Institute cannot: fine an individual or an organisation; award compensation to anyone; require an employer to act, reinstate, or change a report; overturn a commercial decision; correct a project's published numbers; or prevent someone practising in project controls. Its jurisdiction runs to a person's standing with the Institute — their candidature and their certification — and no further.

That is a narrow power. It is also, for a credential that employers rely on, the relevant one.

— 8. Effect on results and credentials

8.1 Where a conduct finding concerns an examination, a result may be invalidated. The consequences for resitting, for fees already paid and for any authorisation are handled under the examination rules for the sitting concerned.

8.2 Where certification is suspended or withdrawn, the person must stop using the designation immediately (ETH-01 §11.5.1), including on professional profiles, signatures, tender documents and company materials. Continued use after withdrawal is a separate and serious breach, and it is the one most likely to be noticed by a third party.

8.3 A credential that has expired for non-renewal is not a sanction and is not recorded as one. Membership grades and certification are separate ladders (ETH-01 §11.5.3); the effect of a conduct outcome on membership standing is governed by the Institute's membership arrangements rather than by this document.

— 9. Appeals

9.1 The right

An adverse decision carries a right of appeal, heard by people independent of the original decision — the **Appeals Panel**. This applies to conduct decisions and to the other decisions that affect a person directly: eligibility, results, invalidation and certification.

9.2 Independence

[CONFIRM: how Appeals Panel members are appointed, how independence from the original decision-maker is assured, and whether an appellant may object to a panel member]

The principle is stated in the Institute's published material and is not in doubt: an appeal is reviewed independently of the people who made the original decision, and raising one never prejudices a person's standing with the Institute.

9.3 Grounds, time limits and fees

[CONFIRM: the time limit for lodging an appeal, the grounds on which an appeal may be brought, whether new evidence may be introduced, and any fee and its refund on a successful appeal]

No timescale, ground or fee is stated in this document, because none may be invented. Where a candidate needs those facts today, they are in the examination rules and appeals policy published for their sitting, and the platform records the appeal from submission through to decision.

9.4 What an appeal is not

An appeal is not a rehearing of the same argument to a different audience, and it is not a route to challenge a professional judgement simply because the outcome is unwelcome. It examines whether the decision was properly made on the evidence, by the right people, following the process — and, where provided for, whether new material changes the position.

— 10. Protection from detriment — what is ours to give, and what is not

This section is the one most likely to be relied on, so it is written without ambiguity.

10.1 What the Institute undertakes

ETH-01 §13.4.1: the Institute will not treat a person adversely **in their standing with the Institute** because they raised a concern in good faith. Raising a concern is not a mark against a candidate, does not affect an application, an examination, a result or a renewal, and is not disclosed to an employer as a matter of course.

If a person believes they have been treated adversely by the Institute for raising a concern, that is itself a complaint about the Institute (§11), and it goes to a different route from the concern that prompted it.

10.2 What the Institute cannot do — and this matters more

The Institute **cannot** protect a person from their employer's response. It cannot prevent a dismissal, a demotion, the withdrawal of work, exclusion from a project, or the informal disadvantage that is far more common than any of those and far harder to evidence. It cannot compel an employer to do anything, cannot appear for a person in any proceedings, and cannot confer any legal protection whatsoever.

10.3 The legal position varies, and no professional body can tell you what it is

Legal protection for a person who reports wrongdoing differs profoundly between jurisdictions, and within a jurisdiction it differs between sectors, between employees and contractors, and over time. In some places statutory protection exists but is conditional — on the subject matter of the disclosure, on the recipient, on the order in which internal and external routes were used, on the person's belief being reasonable, and on procedural steps taken at the right time. In others it is narrow, hard to enforce, or absent. Confidentiality obligations, contractual terms and data laws may also bear on what a person may lawfully disclose and to whom.

Take advice from a qualified adviser in your own jurisdiction before making a disclosure outside your organisation, before resigning over an ethical matter, and before removing any document from an employer's systems. **ETH-01 §3.3.4.** This is not a formality: in several legal systems the protection available depends on steps taken before the disclosure, which cannot be repaired afterwards.

The Institute does not give legal advice, does not underwrite the consequences of a disclosure, and does not want anyone to read encouragement in this document as an assurance of safety it has no power to provide.

10.4 What is nonetheless worth knowing

Two practical points, offered as advice and not as law. First, the record is what survives: dated, factual notes made at the time, held somewhere you will still have access to if you lose your systems, are the difference between a documented escalation and a recollection. Second, escalating inside the organisation first — where it is safe and sensible to do so — is not only what **ETH-01 §13.1** expects; it is also, in many legal frameworks, the step that makes later protection available at all.

— 11. Complaints about the Institute

A complaint about the Institute's service, process, systems, communications or staff is a different matter from a conduct concern about a person, and goes down its own route. The platform records complaints alongside appeals, with the same states and the same portal-based response.

The Certification & Impartiality Committee's function in PCI's governance is to safeguard the impartiality of certification decisions — which includes the handling of complaints that bear on whether decisions were taken fairly and free of commercial or personal influence.

Complaints about impartiality specifically — that a certification decision was influenced by a commercial relationship, a training relationship, or a personal connection — should say so expressly, because they are routed differently from a service complaint.

— 12. Records and privacy of case material

12.1 Case material contains personal data about the reporter, the person concerned and third parties, and is handled accordingly under the applicable data-protection framework, which varies by jurisdiction (ETH-01 §9.4).

12.2 Material is shared only as fair process requires. The person concerned will ordinarily learn the substance of the allegation; whether they learn the reporter's identity depends on the circumstances and on what the reporter has agreed (§3.2, point 7).

12.3 [CONFIRM: the retention period for conduct case records, and whether an unsubstantiated allegation is retained and for how long]

— 13. If a concern is raised about you

Six things, in order, and they are the same six whether the concern is well-founded or not.

1. **Read what is alleged, precisely.** Most responses answer a broader accusation than the one actually made, and in doing so introduce material nobody had asked about.
 2. **Assemble the contemporaneous record** — the schedule versions, the measurement sheets, the email you sent that afternoon. Do not create anything new and date it as if it were old; that converts a defensible position into a certain finding.
 3. **Do not contact the reporter** to discuss it, and do not attempt to establish who they are.
 4. **Answer honestly, including where you were wrong.** Self-correction is weighed in your favour (§7.3). Concealment is weighed heavily against you, and it is usually the concealment that determines the outcome.
 5. **Take your own advice** where the matter also has legal or employment consequences — the Institute's process and your employer's process are separate, and they can run at different speeds.
 6. **Cooperate.** ETH-01 §11.4.1 requires it, and non-cooperation is a breach in its own right that costs more than almost any answer you could give.
-

— 14. Checklist — before you raise a concern

- [] Which of the three routes is this: conduct, appeal, or complaint about the Institute? (§1)
- [] Have I raised it internally, and what happened — or is there a good reason not to? (§2.3)
- [] Can I state what happened in factual sentences, with dates, without characterisation? (§3.2)
- [] What evidence exists, and what may I properly provide? (§3.4)
- [] Am I raising this honestly and on reasonable grounds? (§3.5)
- [] Am I content to be identified to the person concerned, and if not, why not? (§3.2)
- [] Do I understand what the Institute can and cannot do about it? (§7.5, §10.2)
- [] Have I taken local advice, if this involves disclosing anything outside my organisation? (§10.3)
- [] Have I kept my own dated copy of everything I have sent? (§10.4)

A credential is only worth what happens after it is awarded. A body that publishes a code and no route for enforcing it is publishing an aspiration — and the people most disadvantaged by that are the professionals who followed the code when it cost them something.

— Related

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) — §13 and §14 are the clauses this document operates
- [ETH-03 – Reporting numbers under pressure: a casebook](#) — what escalation looks like before it becomes a case
- [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#) — the conflicts that must be managed inside the process as well as outside it
- [CER-07 – Results, scoring, appeals and complaints](#) — the candidate-facing view of the appeal and complaint routes
- [EXB-07 – Examination security and integrity](#) — how examination misconduct is detected and what follows

— Sources and standards

- [ETH-01 – The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct](#) (this framework) — §11.4, §13 and §14.
 - PCI Candidate Handbook, [docs/downloads/candidate-handbook.md](#), repository copy read August 2026 — the separation of appeals from complaints, the fair-process guarantees, and the statement that raising an appeal never prejudices a candidate's standing.
 - PCI platform casework module, [backend/Endpoints/Casework.cs](#), read August 2026 — the four recorded case types (result appeal, invalidation appeal, complaint, ethics concern), the case states (submitted, under review, upheld, dismissed), and the portal-based response.
-

No external legal source is cited and none should be inferred. The statements in §10.3 about variation in whistleblowing and employment protection are general observations; the only reliable source for any individual's position is a qualified adviser in their own jurisdiction.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.